📚 Daily Editorial Vocabulary — Master List

1219 unique words 20 new today, grouped by meaning so similar words sit together. Updated daily — new words are merged in, duplicates are never repeated. Rows added **today are highlighted** 🆕.

How to use: pick a group, read each *meaning* and *example* aloud, cover the meaning, and recall it.

🧭 Contents

#	Group	Words	New
1	📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken	51	
2	📈 Increase, Rise & Spread	35	
3	💢 Criticism & Condemnation	36	
4	👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen	39	
5	🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress	46	
6	⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder	25	
7	💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen	14	1
8	🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency	38	

#	Group	Words	New
9	❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt	30	
10	🌱 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points	28	
11	💰 Wealth, Money & Economy	34	
12	🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom	25	
13	🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims	23	
14	⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal	19	
15	🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards	9	
16	🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation	26	1
17	⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority	16	
18	〰️ Hidden, Unclear & Secret	16	
19	🧱 Real, Concrete & Practical	12	
20	✊ Reject, Revenge & Force	15	
21	⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach	14	
22	🤥 Lies, Trickery & Deception	12	

#	Group	Words	New
23	🧗 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks	14	
24	🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory	12	
25	⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth	21	
26	🌀 Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness	15	
27	👑 Power, Control & Influence	11	
28	😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity	12	
29	🎱 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant	23	
30	📦 Amount, Size & Plenty	29	
31	◻️ Difference, Comparison & Opposite	11	
32	🪤 Catch, Hold & Seize	5	
33	📌 Cause, Effect & Consequence	13	
34	🔺 Highest & Lowest Points	4	
35	🍀 Luck, Chance & Fate	2	
36	🗨️ Talkative, Loud & Wordy	6	

#	Group	Words	New
37	😢 Sadness, Regret & Complaint	4	
38	🏇 Boldness, Recklessness & Daring	4	
39	😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint	8	
40	□ Unity, Sameness & Division	14	
41	🛠️ Correct, Fix & Improve	5	
42	🪫 Use, Need & Involve	3	
43	🚫 Useless, Hopeless & Empty	3	
44	🧩 Complicated, Confusing & Vague	1	
45	🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour	9	1
46	Other & Mixed	427	17

📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abate	verb	to become less intense	subside, lessen	*The storm finally began to abate by evening.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Allay	verb	to reduce someone's fear or worry	calm, ease	*The government tried to allay public fears about the vaccine.*
Alleviate	verb	to make a problem or pain less severe	reduce, ease, lessen	*The relief package is meant to alleviate the suffering of farmers hit by the floods.*
Attenuate	verb	to make weaker or smaller	weaken, reduce, lessen	*The mask did not stop infection entirely but attenuated the spread of the virus.*
Compromise	noun/verb	a deal where each side gives up something; or to weaken something	deal, middle ground, weaken	*Both parties must compromise if the long-running border talks are to succeed.*
Contraction	noun	a shrinking of the economy or output	shrinking, drop, decline	*GDP recorded its steepest contraction in decades as lockdowns shut down trade.*
Cripple	verb	to seriously damage or weaken	disable, weaken	*The strike crippled public transport for days.*
Curb	verb	to control or reduce something	limit, restrain	*The government announced new rules to curb pollution in the city.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Curtail	verb	to reduce or cut short	cut, limit	*The lockdown curtailed many basic freedoms.*
Dampen	verb	to make a feeling or activity weaker	reduce, weaken, lower	*High interest rates are likely to dampen demand in the housing sector this year.*
de-		down/remove	decrease, devalue, defrost	
Debacle		a total, humiliating failure	fiasco, catastrophe, disaster, collapse	
Debilitate		to weaken	enfeeble, weaken, sap, incapacitate	
Decline		(1) To say no (2) To go down.	Refuse, Reject, Decrease, Diminish	
Deflation	noun	a general fall in prices, often a sign of a weak economy	falling prices, price drop	*Japan battled deflation for years as consumers delayed spending in hope of cheaper goods.*
Dent	noun/verb	to damage or weaken something a little	damage, hurt, harm	*The corruption charges have made a serious dent in the party's image.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Depreciation	noun	a fall in the value of a currency or asset over time	drop, fall, loss of value	*The sharp depreciation of the rupee made imported oil far more expensive for Indian refiners.*
Depression	noun	a very deep and long-lasting economic collapse, worse than a recession	severe slump, crash, deep crisis	*Economists feared the banking crisis might spiral into a full-blown depression.*
Deteriorate	verb	to become worse over time	decline, worsen	*Relations between the two nations continued to deteriorate.*
Diminish	verb	to become or make smaller or less	reduce, shrink	*Public trust in the institution has steadily diminished.*
Dwindle	verb	to slowly shrink or run low	shrink, decline	*Water supplies dwindled during the long drought.*
Ease	verb	to make less severe	reduce, relax	*The bank moved to ease lending rules for small businesses.*
Ebb	verb/noun	to slowly reduce or fade away	fade, fall, sink	*As the festive season ended, the buying enthusiasm in markets began to ebb.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Enervate		to drain of energy	weaken, exhaust, debilitate, sap	
Erode	verb	to gradually wear away or weaken	wear away, weaken	*Corruption has eroded faith in public institutions.*
Feeble		Having little strength.	Weak, Frail, Faint, Delicate	
Fragile	adjective	easily broken or damaged; weak	weak, delicate, breakable	*The ceasefire remains fragile, and any small spark could reignite tensions.*
Halfhearted	adjective	done without real effort or interest	weak, lazy, careless	*A halfhearted enquiry will only deepen public mistrust in the system.*
Hubris	noun	too much pride or over-confidence that leads to a fall	pride, ego, arrogance	*The party's electoral hubris blinded it to growing anger on the ground.*
Jettison	verb	to throw away or abandon something	dump, drop, discard	*The ruling alliance was forced to jettison the unpopular land law after public outcry.*
Kowtow	verb	to obey or please someone powerful in a weak, servile way	bow, give in, flatter	*The editorial warned that regulators must not kowtow to powerful*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				corporate lobbies while framing data-protection rules.
Lag	verb	to move or develop more slowly than others	trail, fall behind, slow	*Rural schools continue to lag behind urban ones in basic facilities.*
Languid	adjective	slow, relaxed, and lacking energy	slow, lazy, weak	*After a languid first half, the budget session finally sprang to life over the contentious farm bill.*
Languish	verb	to remain in a bad or weak state	suffer, stagnate	*Thousands of cases languish in the courts for years.*
Malaise	noun	a general feeling that something is wrong, weak, or unhealthy	unease, weakness, sickness	*The slowdown in manufacturing reflects a deeper malaise in the country's investment climate.*
Mitigate	verb	to make something less harmful or severe	reduce, ease	*New flood barriers were built to mitigate the damage from storms.*
Moribund	adjective	almost dead or about to fail completely	dying, failing, weak	*The package aims to revive a moribund manufacturing sector.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Plummet	verb	to fall very fast and far	drop, tumble	*Exports plummeted after the new tariffs were imposed.*
Plunge	verb	to fall suddenly and steeply	crash, dive	*Stock markets plunged amid global tension.*
Recede	verb	To move back, shrink, or become weaker over time	retreat, shrink, fade	*As inflation receded, central banks began cutting interest rates.*
Recovery	noun	the return of the economy to health after a fall	rebound, comeback, healing	*A fragile recovery took hold as factory output rose for the third straight month.*
Resurgence	noun	a return or rise after a decline	revival, comeback	*The region saw a resurgence of the virus in winter.*
Slump	noun/verb	a big fall or weak period	drop, decline	*The economy is facing a slump as factories cut production.*
Subvert	verb	to secretly weaken or destroy a system or authority	weaken, damage, overthrow	*The court warned that such tactics could subvert the independence of institutions.*
Tenuous	adjective	weak, thin, or not strongly supported	weak, fragile	*The link between the two events is tenuous at*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				best.
Undermine	verb	to secretly weaken something	weaken, sabotage	*False claims undermine public trust in science.*
Unravel	verb	to slowly fall apart or come undone	fall apart, unwind, collapse	*The coalition began to unravel as smaller parties withdrew their support one by one.*
Vulnerable	adjective	easily harmed or at risk	at risk, exposed, weak	*The report warned that the poorest nations remain the most vulnerable to extreme weather.*
Wane	verb	to gradually decrease or weaken	fade, decline	*Public support for the war began to wane.*
Whittle	verb	to slowly reduce something little by little	cut down, reduce, shrink	*Successive delays have whittled down public trust in the housing scheme.*
Wither	verb	to dry up, fade, or weaken	fade, shrivel	*Support for the scheme withered within months.*

📈 Increase, Rise & Spread ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Ascendancy	noun	A position of growing power, control, or dominance over others	rise, power, dominance	*The party's ascendancy reshaped the country's foreign policy for a decade.*
Augment		To add to / make bigger.	Increase, Enlarge, Amplify, Boost	
Autocracy	noun	rule by one person or group with total, unchecked power	one-man rule, dictatorship	*The index warned that several democracies were sliding quietly toward autocracy as leaders weakened the courts.*
Boost	verb/noun	to increase or improve	help, lift	*The new policy aims to boost exports.*
Coerce	verb	to force someone to do something by threat	force, pressure, push	*The report alleged that villagers were coerced into selling their land.*
Compel	verb	to force someone to do something	force, push, make	*Rising fuel prices have compelled many middle-class families to cut back on travel.*
Compound	verb	to make a bad situation even worse	worsen, add to, increase	*Heavy rains compounded the misery of flood-hit villages already short of food.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Diffuse	verb	to spread something widely, or to calm a tense situation	spread, calm, ease	*Quick talks between the two states helped diffuse the tension over the river-water dispute.*
Disseminate		to spread widely	circulate, broadcast, propagate, scatter	
Escalate	verb	to grow quickly and become more serious	grow, rise, increase	*If both sides refuse to talk, a minor border dispute could escalate into a full conflict.*
Escalation	noun	a rise in the intensity of a conflict or dispute	rise, worsening, build-up	*Both sides warned that any further escalation could spark open war.*
Expansion	noun	a period of growing economy and rising output	growth, rise, build-up	*The longest economic expansion on record finally stalled amid the pandemic.*
Famine	noun	A severe, widespread shortage of food causing hunger and death	starvation, hunger, food crisis	*Aid agencies warned that drought could push the region into famine.*
Fester	verb	to grow worse and more harmful over time because it is ignored	rot, worsen, build up	*If grievances of farmers are left unaddressed, the anger will only fester and erupt later.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Germinal	adjective	in the earliest stage; a starting point that things grow from	early, beginning, seed-stage	*The 1953 paper is now seen as a germinal work in the field of genetics.*
Germinate	verb	to begin to grow or develop, like a seed or an idea	sprout, begin, develop	*The idea of a national health scheme germinated decades before it became law.*
Goad	verb	to push or provoke someone into doing something	push, provoke, force	*Opposition members tried to goad the treasury benches into a debate on the fuel price hike.*
Hike	noun/verb	an increase (usually in price or rate)	rise, raise	*A sharp hike in fuel prices has angered commuters.*
Impetus	noun	a force that drives something forward	momentum, push	*The crisis gave fresh impetus to reform.*
Incentive	noun	something that encourages you to act, often a reward	reward, push, reason	*Tax breaks gave companies a strong incentive to invest in clean technology.*
Inflation	noun	the general rise in prices over time	price rise	*Rising inflation has hit middle-class families hard.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Marginalise	verb	to push a group to the edges of society, ignoring their needs	sideline, exclude, push aside	*The policy further marginalised migrant communities already cut off from healthcare and schooling.*
Meritocracy	noun	a system where people rise based on talent and effort, not birth or wealth	earned success, talent rule	*The civil-service exam was designed to build a meritocracy in which ability, not connections, determined advancement.*
Prevalence	noun	how common or widespread something is	commonness, spread, how widespread	*The study found a rising prevalence of diabetes among young adults in cities.*
Proliferate	verb	to increase or spread rapidly	multiply, spread	*Fake news proliferated during the election.*
Rampant	adjective	spreading uncontrollably	widespread, unchecked	*Corruption is rampant in many departments.*
Rife	adjective	very common, usually of something bad	widespread, common, everywhere	*Corruption is rife in the licensing offices, where bribes decide how fast files move.*
Soar	verb	to rise quickly and high	jump, climb	*Vegetable prices soared after heavy rains.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Stimulus	noun	government money or action used to wake up a slow economy	boost, push, support package	*Washington unveiled a $2 trillion stimulus to revive demand during the downturn.*
Surge	noun/verb	a sudden strong increase	rise, spike	*There was a surge in demand for electric cars.*
Thrive	verb	to grow well and become very successful	grow, succeed, do well	*Small businesses began to thrive once the local market reopened.*
Ubiquitous	adjective	present or found everywhere	widespread, omnipresent	*Smartphones have become ubiquitous in modern life.*
Unbridled	adjective	not controlled or held back; without limits	unchecked, wild, free	*Unbridled spending before the elections has pushed the state deep into debt.*
Urge	verb	to strongly request	push, ask	*Doctors urge people to get vaccinated before winter.*
Wax		to increase gradually	grow, increase, expand, swell	

Criticism & Condemnation ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Absolve		to free from blame	exonerate, acquit, pardon, clear	
Accountability	noun	being answerable for your actions, having to explain and take blame	answerability, responsibility	*The report demanded greater accountability from public officials who had mismanaged the relief funds.*
Admonish		To scold / warn firmly.	Reprimand, Rebuke, Reproach, Scold	
Attribute	verb	to say something is caused by a particular thing	credit, blame, link	*The study attributes the fall in crime to better street lighting rather than policing.*
Bemoan	verb	to express sorrow or complaint about	lament, complain	*Farmers bemoaned the lack of fair prices.*
Berate		to scold angrily	rebuke, reprimand, upbraid, chide	
Cacophony		a harsh mix of sounds	din, discord, racket, dissonance	
Calumny		a false damaging statement	slander, defamation, libel, smear	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Censure	verb	to blame or criticise strongly and officially	blame, scold, condemn	*The court did not hesitate to censure the agency for its careless handling of evidence.*
Condemn		To strongly disapprove.	Denounce, Criticise, Censure, Reprove	
Culpable	adjective	deserving blame for a wrong	guilty, responsible, at fault	*The inquiry held three officials culpable for the bridge collapse.*
Denigrate		to belittle/defame	disparage, vilify, malign, deprecate	
Deplore	verb	to strongly disapprove of and feel sad about	condemn, hate, regret	*Editorials across the country deplored the attack on journalists covering the rally.*
Draconian	adjective	extremely harsh and severe (laws)	very harsh	*Activists called the new law draconian.*
Exonerate	verb	to officially declare not guilty	clear, free of blame	*The court exonerated him of all charges.*
Grim	adjective	very serious, gloomy, or unpleasant	bleak, harsh	*The survivors described a grim scene of destruction.*
Harangue	verb/noun	a long, angry, scolding speech	scolding, lecture, rant	*Instead of a policy plan, the minister offered only*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				a harangue against his rivals.
Indictment	noun	a formal charge of a crime, or strong criticism	charge, blame, accusation	*Rising malnutrition figures are a damning indictment of the state's much-publicised welfare schemes.*
Invective	noun	harsh, insulting, abusive language	abuse, insults, harsh words	*Parliamentary debate has degenerated into personal invective rather than reasoned argument.*
Lambast	verb	to criticise harshly	criticise, scold	*The press lambasted the government for inaction.*
Lambaste		to scold harshly	berate, lash out at, censure, upbraid	
Malign	verb	to speak badly about someone unfairly	root MAL=bad; slander, defame	*Rivals tried to malign the minister before the vote.*
Obloquy	noun	strong public criticism and shame	disgrace, blame	*The scandal brought obloquy on the whole party.*
Opprobrium		harsh public disgrace	disgrace, shame, infamy, dishonour	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Regime	noun	a government in power, often one seen as harsh or unelected	government, rulers, ruling power	*The new sanctions target officials close to the ruling regime.*
Relentless		never stopping, harsh	unrelenting, persistent, inexorable, dogged	
Reprehensible	adjective	very bad and deserving strong blame	shameful, wrong, blameworthy	*The court called the police inaction during the riots reprehensible.*
Scathing	adjective	harshly critical	harsh, severe	*The audit was a scathing indictment of the management.*
Slam	verb	to criticise strongly	attack, condemn	*The opposition slammed the budget for ignoring farmers.*
Stark	adjective	harshly clear; severe and plain	harsh, sharp	*The data revealed a stark rise in unemployment.*
Subjugate	verb	To bring a people or country under harsh control by force	conquer, dominate, enslave	*The empire subjugated the coastal tribes and seized their land.*
Tirade	noun	a long angry speech of criticism	rant, outburst	*He launched into a tirade against the media.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Vilify	verb	to speak about someone in a very bad way	defame, smear	*Critics were vilified in the state media.*
Vindicate	verb	to prove someone right or free from blame	justify, clear	*The verdict vindicated the whistle-blower.*
Vitriolic	adjective	full of bitter, cruel and harsh criticism	bitter, harsh, cruel	*The campaign turned vitriolic, with leaders trading personal insults daily.*
Yoke	noun	a heavy burden or harsh control that holds people down	burden, control, weight	*Small traders say the yoke of complex tax rules is crushing their daily business.*

👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abet	verb	to help someone do something wrong	help, support, assist	*The officials were accused of helping and abetting the illegal sand mining along the river.*
Acclaim	noun	strong public praise	praise, applause, honour	*The film won wide acclaim for its honest portrayal of rural life.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Advocate	verb/noun	to publicly support a cause; a supporter	support, champion	*She advocates for stronger laws against child labour.*
Approbation		approval, praise	approval, endorsement, commendation, acclaim	
Backbone	noun	the most important supporting part of something	support, base, main part	*Small farmers remain the backbone of the country's rural economy.*
Bolster	verb	to support or strengthen something	boost, reinforce	*The bank cut rates to bolster the slowing economy.*
Clientelism	noun	trading public favours, jobs or money for political support and votes	favour-trading, vote-buying	*Analysts blamed entrenched clientelism for the way state contracts flowed only to loyal supporters.*
Corroborate	verb	to give extra evidence that supports an idea or claim	confirm, back up, prove	*Independent satellite data corroborate the team's finding that the glacier is melting faster than predicted.*
Demagogue	noun	a leader who wins support by stirring emotions, not facts	crowd-pleaser	*Critics called him a demagogue who exploited fear.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Dialectic	noun	working out the truth by setting two opposing ideas against each other	debate of opposites, back-and-forth reasoning	*The essay traces the dialectic between freedom and security in modern democracies.*
Embolden	verb	to give someone courage to act	encourage, empower	*The win emboldened the protesters to demand more.*
Endorse	verb	to publicly approve or support	back, support	*Several economists endorsed the reform package.*
Enfranchise	verb	to give someone the right to vote or full citizenship rights	give the vote, empower, include	*The amendment enfranchised eighteen-year-olds, adding millions of young people to the voter rolls.*
Espouse	verb	to support or adopt a belief	support, embrace	*The party espouses free-market policies.*
Eulogise		to praise (esp. publicly)	extol, glorify, laud, acclaim	
Foster	verb	to encourage the growth of something	promote, nurture	*The scheme aims to foster innovation among startups.*
Garner	verb	to collect or gather, especially support, votes, or attention	gather, collect, get	*The new welfare scheme has managed to garner wide support across*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				rural districts ahead of the state elections.
Hail	verb	to praise something publicly	praise, welcome	*Leaders hailed the agreement as a historic step.*
Hindsight	noun	understanding a situation only after it has happened	looking back, afterthought	*In hindsight, the regulator should have acted sooner to prevent the banking collapse.*
Keystone	noun	the most important part on which everything else depends	base, main support, anchor	*Affordable public healthcare remains the keystone of any credible welfare promise made before the elections.*
Laud	verb	to praise someone or something publicly	praise, applaud, honour	*Economists lauded the central bank for holding interest rates steady amid global uncertainty.*
Laudable	adjective	deserving praise	praiseworthy, good, admirable	*The scheme's intent is laudable, but its execution on the ground has been poor.*
Partisan	adjective/noun	strongly supporting one side, often unfairly	biased, one-sided, loyal	*The committee's report was dismissed as partisan, written only to favour the ruling party.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Qualified	adjective	limited or partial; not full or complete (of support, praise, etc.)	limited, partial, with conditions	*The committee gave only qualified support to the plan, noting several serious risks.*
Ratify	verb	to formally approve an agreement or treaty	approve, confirm	*Parliament voted to ratify the climate treaty.*
re-		again/back	rewrite, return, rebuild, revise	
Recoup	verb	to get back money or losses	recover, regain, get back	*Airlines are struggling to recoup losses suffered during the lockdown.*
Repatriate	verb	to send someone back to their own country	send home, return, bring back	*Aid agencies are working to repatriate refugees once the fighting ends.*
Rescind	verb	to cancel or take back an order or decision	cancel, undo, withdraw	*Facing protests, the government was forced to rescind the controversial order.*
Resilience	noun	the ability to recover quickly after a shock or disaster	toughness, bounce-back, strength	*The IMF stressed building economic resilience so countries can withstand future climate shocks.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Sanction	noun/verb	a penalty against a country, or official permission	penalty, approve	*The nation faced harsh sanctions over its nuclear programme.*
Stalwart		loyal and reliable; strong	dependable, staunch, sturdy, steadfast	
Staunch	adjective	very loyal and firm	loyal, firm	*She is a staunch supporter of the reform.*
Steadfast		firmly loyal/unwavering	resolute, staunch, unwavering, devoted	
Stifle	verb	to stop something from developing or being expressed	block, smother, hold back	*Harsh defamation laws can stifle free speech and honest reporting.*
Substantiate	verb	to prove with evidence; to back up a claim	prove, support, back up	*The newspaper could not substantiate the allegations and issued a public correction.*
Underpin	verb	to support or form the base of something	support, back, hold up	*Strong institutions and the rule of law underpin long-term economic growth, the World Bank study argues.*
Unfettered	adjective	free, with no rules or chains holding it back	free, unrestricted, loose	*The court ruled that free speech cannot be unfettered when it incites violence.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Woo	verb	to try to attract or win support	attract	*Both parties are trying to woo young voters.*

🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Annex	verb	to take control of and add another's territory to your own	take over, seize, add	*The state moved to annex the disputed valley, drawing global condemnation.*
Avert	verb	to stop something bad from happening	prevent, stop, avoid	*Timely talks between the two sides helped avert a major strike.*
Blockade	noun	Sealing off a place to stop goods or people from entering or leaving	blocking, sealing off, siege	*The naval blockade prevented food and medicine from reaching the port city.*
Ceasefire	noun	an agreement to stop fighting, at least for a while	truce, stop fighting, pause	*A fragile ceasefire allowed aid trucks to reach the besieged city.*
Co-opt	verb	to win someone over and absorb them so they stop opposing you	win over, absorb, take in	*The ruling party tried to co-opt the protest leaders by offering them seats in government.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Complacent	adjective	too satisfied so that you stop trying	smug, lazy, careless	*Health officials cannot afford to be complacent even as new cases begin to fall.*
Cumbersome	adjective	slow, heavy, and hard to use	clumsy, awkward	*The approval process is cumbersome and slow.*
Derail	verb	to spoil a plan or process so it cannot continue	spoil, stop, ruin	*Repeated walkouts by the opposition threatened to derail the entire winter session of Parliament.*
Deter	verb	to discourage someone from doing something	discourage, stop, prevent	*Stricter penalties are meant to deter people from breaking traffic rules.*
Disrupt	verb	to interrupt and stop the normal flow of something	interrupt, break, stop	*Heavy rains disrupted rail and road traffic across the western coast for two full days.*
Docile		Easy to control / teach.	Obedient, Submissive, Compliant, Meek	
Embargo	noun	an official ban on trade with a country	trade ban, blockade, stop	*The arms embargo cut off the regime's supply of new weapons.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Forestall	verb	to act early to stop something from happening	prevent, stop, block	*The bank cut rates to forestall a deeper economic downturn.*
Fractious	adjective	easily angered and hard to control; quarrelsome	angry, touchy, restless	*Holding together a fractious alliance will test the new leadership.*
Halt	verb/noun	to stop	stop, pause	*Train services came to a halt due to the strike.*
Hamper	verb	to slow down or get in the way of progress	hinder, obstruct	*Heavy rain hampered rescue operations.*
Hegemony	noun	control or dominance of one group over others	dominance, control	*The treaty challenged the region's old hegemony.*
Hinder	verb	to make something harder or slow it down	block, slow, delay	*Poor road connectivity continues to hinder the growth of rural industries.*
Impede	verb	to block or slow progress	hinder, block	*Red tape continues to impede small businesses.*
Incremental	adjective	happening in small steps rather than all at once	step-by-step, gradual, slow	*Progress on the disease has been incremental, with each study adding a little.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Indolent	adjective	lazy and avoiding work or effort	lazy, idle, slow	*The report blames an indolent bureaucracy for the long delay in clearing pending files.*
Inexorable	adjective	impossible to stop	unstoppable	*The inexorable rise of automation is changing jobs.*
Insidious	adjective	harmful in a slow, hidden way	sneaky, harmful	*Misinformation spreads in an insidious manner.*
Insidiously	adverb	in a slow, hidden, harmful way	secretly, slowly, sneakily	*Communal prejudice spreads insidiously through everyday speech long before it erupts into violence.*
Interdict	verb	to stop or block something officially	block, stop, ban	*Coast Guard ships moved to interdict the boats suspected of smuggling contraband.*
Intractable	adjective	very hard to solve or control	stubborn, hard, difficult	*The water-sharing dispute between the two states has proved intractable despite years of talks.*
Moratorium	noun	An official temporary stop or pause on an activity	pause, halt, freeze	*The country declared a moratorium on whaling to let stocks recover.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Obtuse		slow to understand	dull, dense, slow-witted, stupid	
Obviate		to remove/prevent (a need)	preclude, forestall, avert, prevent	
Palliative	adjective/noun	giving short-term relief but not curing the real problem	soothing, temporary, stop-gap	*Critics argued that the cash handout was a mere palliative that ignored the deeper crisis of rural unemployment.*
Pernicious	adjective	harmful in a slow, hidden way	harmful, damaging	*Misinformation has a pernicious effect on democracy.*
Preclude	verb	to prevent something from happening; to rule it out	prevent, stop, block	*A lack of funding need not preclude high-quality research, the editorial insists.*
Privatisation	noun	transfer of a company or organization from government to private ownership and control		*Fight them for the beaches: the real villain of Europe's overtourism is big business | Adam Almeida From Albania to Portugal, privatisation of the coastline is bringing locals out on to the streets.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Quell	verb	to stop or suppress something, often by force	suppress, calm	*Police were called in to quell the riots.*
Repression	noun	the use of force or control to stop people's freedom or protest	crackdown, control, holding down	*Human-rights groups documented growing repression as the state silenced journalists and banned rallies.*
Sovereignty	noun	a country's full power to rule itself without outside control	independence, self-rule, control	*Beijing insists that any foreign comment on the islands is an attack on its sovereignty.*
Stall	verb	to stop or delay something on purpose or by problem	delay, stop, hold up	*The talks stalled after both sides refused to soften their demands.*
Stem	verb	to stop or slow down something bad from spreading	stop, check, control	*The new rules aim to stem the flow of black money in the market.*
Stymie	verb	to prevent or block something	block, thwart	*Political disputes stymied the relief effort.*
Subdue	verb	to bring under control	control, calm	*Authorities struggled to subdue the spreading unrest.*
Threshold	noun	the point at which something starts to	limit, starting point, boundary	*Temperatures are nearing the threshold*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		happen or change		*beyond which coral reefs cannot recover.*
Throttle	verb	to control or choke; to limit severely	choke, restrict	*New rules could throttle online free speech.*
Thwart	verb	to prevent someone from doing something	foil, block	*Security forces thwarted a major attack.*
Tussle	noun	a struggle or fight, usually for power or control	fight, struggle, clash	*The tussle between the Centre and the states over fund sharing has delayed many projects.*
Voluble		speaking fluently/non-stop	talkative, loquacious, garrulous, glib	
Wayward	adjective	hard to control; doing wrong or unexpected things	unruly, stubborn, wild	*The party struggled to rein in its wayward members who openly defied the leadership.*

⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Adversity		A time of trouble / bad luck.	Hardship, Misfortune, Affliction, Tribulation	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Bane	noun	a cause of great trouble or ruin	curse, scourge	*Unemployment is the bane of the youth.*
Belligerent	adjective	acting in an aggressive, war-ready way	hostile, aggressive, fighting	*The minister's belligerent speech raised fears of a wider conflict.*
Diplomacy	noun	the work of managing relations between countries through talks, not war	talks, negotiation, foreign relations	*After months of quiet diplomacy, the two governments agreed to reopen their embassies.*
Discord	noun	disagreement and lack of harmony	conflict, fighting, quarrel	*Growing discord within the alliance threatens the stability of the state government.*
Hostilities	noun	acts of war or open fighting	fighting, war, combat	*Hostilities resumed within hours of the ceasefire collapsing.*
Imbroglio		a complicated messy situation	entanglement, muddle, predicament, mess	
Impasse	noun	a situation where no progress is possible; a deadlock	deadlock, standstill, dead end	*Talks between the unions and the management reached an impasse over the question of minimum wages.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Mar	verb	to spoil or damage	spoil, ruin	*Violence marred the otherwise peaceful rally.*
Morass	noun	a confusing and difficult situation that is hard to escape	mess, trap, swamp	*The project sank into a legal morass of clearances, appeals and stay orders that lasted a decade.*
Neutrality	noun	the policy of not taking sides in a conflict	non-involvement, staying out, fairness	*The small state has guarded its neutrality through every regional war.*
Plight	noun	A difficult, dangerous, or sad situation someone is stuck in	trouble, hardship, distress	*The report highlighted the plight of refugees stranded at the border.*
Predicament	noun	a difficult situation with no easy way out	trouble, fix	*Migrant workers were left in a desperate predicament.*
Proxy	noun	a person or group acting for another, often in a hidden war	stand-in, agent, substitute	*Analysts describe the fighting as a proxy war between two larger powers.*
Quagmire	noun	a difficult situation hard to escape	mess, mire	*The war turned into a costly quagmire.*
Reparations	noun	money paid by a country to make up for	compensation, payback, damages	*The treaty required the defeated nation to pay*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		war damage or harm		*heavy reparations.*
Reprieve	noun	a temporary relief from trouble or punishment	respite, relief	*Falling prices gave consumers a brief reprieve.*
Schadenfreude	noun	pleasure at another person's trouble	gloating	*There was open schadenfreude when the rival firm collapsed.*
Spark	verb	to cause or start (usually trouble)	trigger, cause	*The remark sparked protests across the state.*
Stalemate	noun	a situation where no side can win or move forward	deadlock, impasse	*Talks ended in a stalemate, with neither side willing to compromise.*
Tumultuous	adjective	Full of noise, disorder, or violent change; very unsettled	stormy, chaotic, wild	*The nation endured a tumultuous decade of coups and uprisings.*
Turbulent	adjective	full of trouble, sudden change, or conflict	stormy, restless, unsettled	*The state passed through a turbulent decade of unrest before peace talks finally began.*
Turmoil	noun	a state of great confusion or disorder	chaos, unrest	*The country was plunged into political turmoil.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Upheaval	noun	a big and sudden change or disturbance	upset, turmoil	*The reforms caused major social upheaval.*
Vex	verb	to annoy, worry, or trouble someone	annoy, bother, trouble	*The unresolved border dispute continues to vex relations between the two neighbours.*

💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Aggravate		To make worse.	Worsen, Intensify, Exacerbate, Inflame	
Baleful		threatening harm/evil	menacing, sinister, malignant, ominous	
Deleterious		causing harm	harmful, damaging, detrimental, injurious	
Detrimental	adjective	causing harm or damage	harmful, damaging, bad	*Experts warn that cutting research funding would be detrimental to the country's future progress.*
Exacerbate	verb	to make a bad situation worse	worsen, aggravate	*Cutting subsidies could exacerbate the crisis for poor families.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Fallout	noun	the bad results that come after an event	result, effect, damage	*The political fallout from the scandal continued to trouble the ruling party.*
Inflict	verb	to cause harm or suffering	impose, cause	*The sanctions inflicted heavy losses on the economy.*
Jeopardise	verb	to put something at risk	endanger, risk	*The leak could jeopardise national security.*
Machinations	noun	secret clever plans or scheming to do harm	plotting, scheming, tricks	*The fall of the coalition was blamed on the backroom machinations of a handful of power brokers.*
Malevolent		wishing harm to others	spiteful, malicious, hostile, vindictive	
Mollycoddle		to overprotect / pamper	pamper, indulge, coddle, spoil	
Retaliation NEW	noun	Violent or otherwise punitive response to an act of harm or perceived injustice		*Iran earlier promised strong retaliation.*
Subprime	adjective	describing loans to borrowers with poor credit and high risk	high-risk, low-quality, shaky	*The 2008 crash was triggered by defaults on*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				subprime mortgages across America.
Wreak	verb	to cause great harm or damage	inflict, cause	*The floods wreaked havoc across the state.*

🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abrupt	adjective	sudden and unexpected	sudden, quick, sharp	*The minister's abrupt resignation took even his own party by surprise.*
Acute	adjective	severe and serious	severe, sharp	*The city faces an acute shortage of drinking water.*
Astute		clever and shrewd	shrewd, sharp, canny, perceptive	
Austerity	noun	strict economic policy with reduced spending	cutbacks, thrift	*Years of austerity led to widespread protests across the country.*
Avarice		extreme greed for wealth	greed, cupidity, rapacity, covetousness	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Bleak	adjective	without hope or encouragement	gloomy, grim	*The report painted a bleak picture of the job market.*
Compelling	adjective	very convincing or forceful	convincing, strong	*The lawyer made a compelling case for reform.*
Daunting	adjective	seeming difficult and scary to face	intimidating, tough	*Rebuilding the city is a daunting task.*
Dearth		a serious shortage	scarcity, lack, paucity, deficiency	
Despondent	adjective	feeling very low and without hope	sad, hopeless, gloomy	*After three failed monsoons, despondent farmers across the region demanded immediate relief.*
Dichotomy		a sharp division in two	split, contrast, division, separation	
Dire	adjective	extremely serious or urgent	grave, severe	*Aid agencies warned of a dire humanitarian crisis.*
Discourse	noun	the whole serious discussion and writing about a topic in society	public discussion, debate, the talk	*Climate change now dominates the public discourse in many wealthy nations.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Dismal	adjective	very poor, gloomy and disappointing	poor, sad, bad	*The dismal performance of the manufacturing sector dragged down the quarter's growth figures.*
Drastic	adjective	extreme and sudden in effect	extreme, sudden, big	*The pandemic forced state governments to take drastic steps to slow the spread of infection.*
Emphatic	adjective	said in a strong, clear and forceful way	strong, firm, clear	*The Prime Minister gave an emphatic assurance that the scheme would not be scrapped.*
Endeavour	noun	a serious effort to achieve something	effort, attempt, try	*The campaign is a sincere endeavour to make villages free of open drains.*
Fervent	adjective	showing very strong feeling	passionate, intense	*She made a fervent appeal for peace.*
Frivolous		not serious, silly	flippant, trivial, superficial, petty	
Gloss over	phrasal verb	to hide or ignore something bad to make it seem less serious	hide, ignore, cover	*The minister's speech tried to gloss over the delays that have plagued the highway project for years.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Gruelling	adjective	very tiring and difficult	tiring, tough, hard	*After a gruelling round of negotiations, the two parties finally reached a power-sharing agreement.*
Hardliner	noun	someone who holds strict, uncompromising views, often in politics	tough one, strict person, firm one	*Hardliners in the cabinet rejected any talks with the rebels.*
Jingoism	noun	extreme, aggressive love of one's country	blind pride, nationalism, boasting	*Sober debate gave way to jingoism whenever the border issue was raised.*
Keen	adjective	eager or sharply aware	eager, sharp	*There is keen interest in the new policy.*
Lenient	adjective	not strict; gentle in punishment	soft, gentle, easy	*The opposition accused the agency of being lenient with powerful offenders.*
Levity	noun	a lack of seriousness; treating something serious as a joke	joking, lightness, fun	*Treating a grave farmer-distress crisis with such levity does the ruling party no credit.*
Lugubrious	adjective	looking or sounding very sad and gloomy	gloomy, sad, dismal	*There was a lugubrious mood in the markets as one weak earnings report followed another.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Mitigation	noun	action taken to make a problem less serious	easing, reducing, softening	*Climate mitigation focuses on cutting emissions, while adaptation prepares us for warming already locked in.*
Onerous	adjective	needing much effort; heavy and hard to bear	heavy, hard, tough	*Small businesses say the new compliance rules are far too onerous to follow.*
Perspicacious		having sharp insight	astute, shrewd, discerning, perceptive	
Plea	noun	an urgent and emotional request	request, appeal, call	*The court rejected the plea to delay the eviction of street vendors.*
Pledge	verb/noun	to make a serious promise	promise, vow, commit	*The minister pledged to double spending on public health this year.*
Resilient	adjective	able to recover quickly from difficulty	tough, sturdy	*The economy proved resilient despite the pandemic shock.*
Starvation	noun	condition of severe suffering due to a lack of nutrition		*The alarm was raised repeatedly last year as the starvation siege of*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				El Fasher in north Darfur deepened.
Stringent	adjective	strict and severe	strict, tough	*The agency imposed stringent safety standards on factories.*
Trenchant	adjective	sharp, clear, and forceful (about words or criticism)	sharp, strong, biting	*In a trenchant editorial, the paper exposed the loopholes in the new labour law.*
Vehement	adjective	showing strong, intense feeling	fierce, forceful	*He was a vehement critic of the new law.*
Zealot	noun	a person with extreme, uncompromising views	fanatic, extremist	*A few zealots derailed the peace talks.*

❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Acrimonious		bitter and angry (dispute)	bitter, rancorous, caustic, hostile	
Ambiguous	adjective	unclear, having more than one meaning	confusing, unclear	*The law's ambiguous wording has confused officials.*
Arbitrate	verb	To act as a neutral judge to settle a	judge, settle, referee	*The UN agreed to arbitrate the border*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		dispute between two sides		*dispute between the two nations.*
Deficit	noun	when spending is more than income	shortage, gap	*India is working to reduce its fiscal deficit.*
Deviation	noun	how far a value moves away from the usual or expected one	difference, drift, gap	*A small deviation from the normal range was recorded in the final week.*
dis-		opposite/away	disagree, dishonest, disappear	
Discrepancy	noun	a difference between two things that should match	mismatch, gap, difference	*Auditors flagged a serious discrepancy between the reported spending and the actual records.*
Disparity	noun	a big or unfair difference	gap, inequality	*There is a wide disparity between rich and poor regions.*
Equivocal		deliberately vague	ambiguous, evasive, vague, noncommittal	
Fissure	noun	a deep crack or split, often between groups	crack, split, gap	*Deep fissures within the coalition threatened to bring down the government.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Gulf	noun	a very wide gap or difference between two things	gap, divide, distance	*The widening gulf between the rich and the poor remains the country's most pressing challenge.*
Hiatus		a pause or gap	break, interval, gap, lull	
Inconclusive	adjective	not giving a clear answer or final result	unclear, undecided, open	*The early findings were inconclusive, so the team called for further research.*
Indubitable		impossible to doubt	unquestionable, undeniable, certain	
Interlocutor	noun	a person appointed to talk and negotiate, especially in a dispute	negotiator, talker, go-between	*The Centre named a senior interlocutor to begin dialogue with the agitating farmers.*
Interregnum	noun	a gap period between two governments or rulers	gap, in-between, pause	*During the political interregnum, key reforms were left hanging in uncertainty.*
Lacuna	noun	a gap or missing part, especially in a law or argument	gap, hole, missing piece	*The new data-protection bill leaves a serious lacuna by not covering government surveillance.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Margin	noun	the small extra amount or gap, often of error or difference	gap, edge, difference	*The poll has a margin of error of plus or minus three percentage points.*
Mediate	verb	to help two sides settle a dispute	settle, help, intervene	*The Centre offered to mediate between the two states over the river dispute.*
Nebulous	adjective	vague, unclear and hard to understand	vague, unclear, fuzzy	*The scheme rests on nebulous targets that no one can actually measure.*
Nuance	noun	a small but important difference in meaning	subtlety, shade	*The debate ignored the nuances of the issue.*
Obfuscate	verb	to deliberately make something unclear	confuse, hide	*The reply only obfuscated the real cost of the project.*
Obscure	adjective/verb	not well known or hard to understand; to hide	unclear, hide	*The real cause remains obscure to investigators.*
Opaque	adjective	hard to see through or understand	unclear, murky	*The deal's terms remain opaque to the public.*
Parley	noun/verb	a formal talk to settle a dispute	talk, discussion, negotiation	*After weeks of tension, the two parties agreed to a parley over the contentious border issue.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Uncertainty	noun	the range of doubt in a measurement or result	doubt, unsureness, error	*The forecast carried a high degree of uncertainty about future warming.*
Unequivocal	adjective	completely clear, leaving no doubt	clear, plain, certain	*The panel issued an unequivocal warning that emissions must fall this decade.*
Unequivocally	adverb	In a way that leaves no doubt	expressly, unambiguously	*Australian PM apologises for 'inappropriate' comments about Kylie Minogue Albanese has apologised 'unequivocally' after his remarks prompted a backlash.*
Vacillate	verb	to keep changing your mind; be unable to decide	waver, hesitate, doubt	*The committee vacillated for months, leaving the disaster victims without any relief.*
Vague	adjective	not clear or definite	unclear, hazy	*The promise was vague and lacked detail.*

🌱 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Adamant		Refusing to change your mind.	Stubborn, Obstinate, Inflexible, Unyielding	
Adaptation	noun	changing in order to cope with new conditions	adjustment, change, coping	*Coastal cities are spending billions on adaptation measures such as sea walls against rising tides.*
Amend	verb	to officially change or correct a law or text	change, fix, correct	*Parliament is expected to amend the law to close the loophole.*
Baseline	noun	a starting level used to measure later change	starting point, base, level	*Doctors recorded each patient's baseline weight before the diet began.*
Catalyst	noun	something that causes change or action	trigger, spark	*The protest became a catalyst for nationwide reform.*
Correlate	verb	to have a connection where things change together	link, match, relate	*Higher pollution levels correlated strongly with rising rates of asthma.*
Correlation	noun	a link where two things change together (when one goes up, the other goes up or down)	link, connection, relationship	*The paper found a strong correlation between air pollution and hospital visits for asthma.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Entrench	verb	to fix something so firmly that it is very hard to change	fix firmly, settle, root	*Decades of red tape have entrenched corruption deep within the system.*
Fledgling	adjective/noun	new and inexperienced	young, budding	*The fledgling democracy faced many challenges.*
Heterodox	adjective	not following accepted or usual beliefs	unusual, different, new	*The economist proposed a heterodox remedy that mainstream policymakers dismissed.*
Hidebound	adjective	stuck in old ways and unwilling to change	rigid, old-fashioned, narrow	*Reform stalls because a hidebound bureaucracy resists every new idea.*
Inertia	noun	a lack of movement or unwillingness to change	sluggishness, apathy	*Bureaucratic inertia delayed the much-needed reform.*
Intervention	noun	an action taken to change or improve a situation	action, step in, help	*Early health interventions, such as vaccines, save millions of children each year.*
Intransigent	adjective	refusing to change one's view	stubborn, rigid	*Both sides remained intransigent, and talks failed.*
Kindle	verb	to start or arouse a feeling	spark, ignite	*The speech kindled hope among the people.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Nascent	adjective	just beginning to develop	new, emerging	*The nascent industry needs government support.*
Obdurate	adjective	stubbornly refusing to change	stubborn	*The management stayed obdurate despite the strike.*
Obstinate	adjective	refusing to change one's mind even when wrong	stubborn, hard-headed, fixed	*The government's obstinate refusal to talk to the protesters only deepened the crisis.*
Outset	noun	the very beginning of something	start, beginning, opening	*From the outset, the policy lacked a clear plan to fund its lofty promises.*
Overhaul	noun/verb	a thorough change or repair of a system	revamp, reform	*The tax system is due for a major overhaul.*
Prompt	verb	to cause something to happen or make someone act	cause, lead to, trigger	*The factory fire prompted a fresh review of safety rules in the area.*
Tentative	adjective	not final or sure; just a first try that may change	unsure, temporary, not fixed	*Researchers offered only a tentative explanation, warning that more data was needed before any firm conclusion.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Transition	noun	the process of changing from one state to another	shift, change, switch	*The IMF backed a fair transition for workers as the country moves away from coal.*
Usher	verb	to bring in or begin a new period	introduce, herald	*The reforms ushered in a new era of growth.*
Variable	noun	a factor that can change and is measured in a study	factor, element, condition	*Income, age, and diet were the main variables the scientists tracked over ten years.*
Vicissitude	noun	a change of fortune, ups and downs	ups and downs	*The industry has survived many vicissitudes.*
Volatile	adjective	likely to change suddenly and unpredictably	unstable, erratic	*Oil prices remained volatile amid the conflict.*
Watershed	noun	a turning point that changes everything	turning point, milestone	*The verdict was a watershed moment for civil rights.*

💰 Wealth, Money & Economy ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Affluent	adjective	wealthy; having plenty of money	rich, prosperous	*The policy mainly benefits affluent households.*
Allocate	verb	to give out money or resources for a particular purpose	give, share out, set aside	*Parliament allocated two billion dollars to renewable energy in the new budget.*
Arrears	noun	money owed that should have been paid earlier	overdue payments, unpaid dues, backlog	*Millions of households fell into arrears on rent as living costs spiralled.*
Bailout	noun	emergency money given to rescue a failing bank, firm or country	rescue, lifeline, financial rescue	*The government approved a massive bailout to stop the airline from going under.*
Billionaires	noun	Somebody whose wealth is greater than one billion dollars, or other currency	milliardaire	*California might bet its future on the notion that billionaires won't leave.*
Coffer	noun	A store of money or funds belonging to a government or organisation	treasury, funds, money store	*Falling oil prices drained the kingdom's once-overflowing coffers.*
Creditor	noun	a person or institution that is owed money	lender, money-owner, the one owed	*Creditors agreed to restructure the loans to*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				avoid pushing the firm into collapse.
Cupidity		greed for money	avarice, greed, acquisitiveness	
Destitute	adjective	Extremely poor, lacking food, money, and the basics to live	poor, penniless, broke	*The conflict left thousands of families destitute and dependent on aid.*
Embezzle	verb	To steal money that you were trusted to look after, usually at work	steal, pocket, misuse	*The minister was jailed for embezzling millions from the relief fund.*
Fiscal	adjective	relating to government spending, taxes and budgets	money-related, budget, tax	*The finance ministry tightened fiscal policy to bring the soaring deficit under control.*
Fritter	verb	to waste money, time or chances little by little on unimportant things	waste, squander, throw away	*The state must not fritter away its budget surplus on populist freebies before the polls.*
Frugal	adjective	careful with money, not wasteful	careful, saving, thrifty	*In a year of slowing growth, households turned more frugal with their spending.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Halcyon	adjective	peaceful, happy and prosperous (usually about the past)	calm, happy, peaceful	*Many recall the halcyon days of high growth before the global slowdown set in.*
Indebtedness	noun	the condition of owing a large amount of money	debt load, owing money, debt burden	*Household indebtedness reached record highs as families borrowed to cover rising bills.*
Largesse	noun	generous giving of money or gifts, often by the powerful	giving, generosity, handouts	*Pre-election largesse in the form of free schemes has strained the state's finances.*
Leverage	noun	the use of borrowed money to try to make bigger profits	borrowed money, debt power, gearing	*The bank's heavy leverage magnified its losses when asset prices tumbled.*
Liquidity	noun	how easily money or assets can be spent or sold quickly	ready cash, spendable money, cash flow	*The central bank pumped liquidity into banks to keep lending from freezing up.*
Livelihood	noun	the way someone earns money to live	income, job, living	*Drought has destroyed the livelihoods of millions of farmers across the Sahel, the agency reported.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Lucrative	adjective	producing a lot of money or profit	profitable, rich	*The firm won a lucrative contract to build the highway.*
Magnate	noun	a rich and powerful business person	root MAGN=great; tycoon, baron	*A steel magnate funded the new hospital.*
Monetary	adjective	relating to money supply and interest rates set by a central bank	money, cash, interest-rate	*The Federal Reserve signalled a shift to looser monetary policy to support growth.*
Opulent		Very rich / luxurious.	Wealthy, Rich, Luxurious, Affluent	
Ostentatious	adjective	showing off wealth to impress	showy, flashy	*The ostentatious wedding drew public criticism.*
Plutocracy	noun	a society or government controlled by the very rich	rule by the rich, money rule	*Economists warned that rising inequality risked turning the republic into a plutocracy dominated by a few billionaires.*
Profligate	adjective	wasteful, especially with money or resources	wasteful, reckless, extravagant	*Economists warned that profligate spending ahead of the polls would blow a hole in the budget.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Prosperity	noun	condition of being prosperous, of having good fortune	affluence, richdom, weal	*Where, indeed, was any real sign of even the beginnings of the 21st-century prosperity Blair seemed to be offering?*
Redistribution	noun	sharing wealth or resources more evenly, often through taxes and welfare	sharing out, spreading, reallocation	*The reform package leaned on redistribution, taxing high earners to fund services for the poor.*
Remittance	noun	money sent home by workers living abroad	money sent home, transfer	*Remittances from Gulf workers remain a vital source of foreign income for India.*
Sanitation	noun	hygienic disposal or recycling of waste		*Need for inclusive, integrated climate action Climate and heat considerations should be integrated into occupational health policies for municipal and contracted sanitation workers*
Squander	verb	to waste something valuable	waste, fritter	*The country squandered its oil wealth on vanity projects.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Stagnation	noun	a long period with no economic growth or improvement	standstill, no growth, stuck state	*Years of stagnation left the country's wages flat while neighbours surged ahead.*
Subsidy	noun	money the government gives to lower a cost	financial help	*Farmers receive a subsidy on fertilisers.*
Venal	adjective	ready to do wrong for money; corrupt	corrupt, greedy, bribable	*A venal officialdom turns even basic public services into a marketplace for bribes.*

🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Acumen	noun	the skill to think and judge quickly and well	sharpness, skill, sense	*Her political acumen helped the party win seats even in difficult constituencies.*
Adept	adjective	very skilled at something	skilled, expert	*She is adept at handling difficult negotiations.*
Adroit		skilful, clever	deft, dexterous, skilful, nimble	
Cautious		Taking care to avoid danger.	Careful, Wary, Prudent, Circumspect	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Coherent	adjective	clear, logical, and easy to understand	clear, logical, sensible	*The government has yet to present a coherent strategy to tackle rising unemployment.*
Comprehensive	adjective	complete and covering everything	complete, full, thorough	*The committee called for a comprehensive review of the country's labour laws.*
Deft	adjective	skilful and quick	skilful, nimble	*A deft handling of the crisis won her praise.*
Diligent	adjective	hard-working and careful	careful, hard-working, sincere	*Only diligent follow-up by officials ensured the project was finished on time.*
Estimate	noun	a careful guess of an amount based on the information you have	guess, rough figure, calculation	*The IMF's latest estimate puts global growth at just under three percent this year.*
Feasibility	noun	whether something is possible and practical to do	doability, practicality, workability	*The agency commissioned a feasibility study before funding the solar plant.*
Feasible	adjective	possible and practical to do	possible, doable, practical	*Critics doubt whether the ambitious plan is financially feasible.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Husbandry	noun	careful management of resources	care, management, saving	*Prudent fiscal husbandry, not reckless spending, is what the struggling economy demands.*
Inept	adjective	lacking skill; clumsy	incompetent, clumsy	*The response to the disaster was widely called inept.*
Meticulous	adjective	very careful and paying great attention to detail	careful, thorough, exact	*The agency's meticulous investigation left the accused with little room to escape the charges.*
Nimble		Quick and light in movement.	Agile, Quick, Sprightly, Deft	
Nuanced	adjective	showing fine, careful differences and detail	subtle, detailed, careful	*The journalist offered a nuanced account that resisted easy heroes and villains.*
Painstaking	adjective	done with great care and effort	careful, thorough	*Restoring the temple took painstaking work.*
Pragmatic	adjective	dealing with things practically, not idealistically	practical, sensible	*The leader took a pragmatic approach to the trade dispute.*
Prudent	adjective	careful and sensible	wise, cautious	*Prudent spending helped the state avoid*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				debt.
Sagacious		Having good judgment.	Wise, Shrewd, Astute, Perceptive	
Sage		profoundly wise	wise, sagacious, prudent, judicious	
Scrutiny	noun	careful and critical examination	inspection, review	*The deal came under intense scrutiny from regulators.*
Systematic	adjective	done in an organized, methodical way	orderly, planned, careful	*A systematic review examined every published trial on the drug.*
Viable	adjective	able to work or succeed practically	workable, possible, practical	*Solar power is now a viable alternative for many rural households.*
Wary	adjective	cautious about possible danger	cautious, careful	*Investors remained wary of the new market.*

🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Allege	verb	to say someone did something wrong, without proof yet	claim, accuse	*The report alleges that the company hid its losses.*
Arguably	adverb	it can be reasonably claimed; one could make a good case for it	possibly, you could say, perhaps	*This is arguably the most important climate report published in the last decade.*
Blame	verb/noun	to say someone is responsible for something bad	fault, accuse, hold responsible	*Opposition leaders were quick to blame the government for the power cuts.*
Breach	noun	the breaking of a rule, law, or promise	break, violation, breaking	*The data leak was described as a serious breach of citizens' privacy.*
Collateral	noun	something valuable promised to a lender in case a loan is not repaid	security, pledge, backing	*Borrowers were forced to put up property as collateral for the emergency loans.*
Contend	verb	to argue or claim that something is true; to compete	argue, claim, compete	*Critics contend that the new policy favours large corporations over small traders.*
Covenant	noun	A formal, often binding agreement or promise between parties	agreement, promise, pact	*The UN covenant commits signatory*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				states to protect basic human rights.
dict		say/speak	dictate, predict, contradict, verdict	
Eloquent		Speaking well and convincingly.	Articulate, Fluent, Expressive, Persuasive	
Implicit		implied, not directly said	tacit, understood, inferred, unspoken	
Implore	verb	to beg earnestly	beg, plead	*Aid groups implored the world to send help.*
Indict	verb	to formally accuse of a crime	root DICT=say; charge, accuse	*The officials were indicted for corruption.*
Laconic	adjective	using very few words; brief in speech	short, brief, few words	*The minister's laconic reply to pointed questions only deepened suspicions of a cover-up.*
Panacea	noun	a cure for all problems (usually said it is NOT one)	cure-all	*Technology is not a panacea for poverty.*
per se	phrase	'in itself' - used to say a thing on its own, not its effects or links	in itself, by itself	*The policy is not harmful per se, but its timing worried investors.*
Populism	noun	a style of politics that claims to speak for	people-first politics, mass appeal	*The rise of populism across Europe has*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		ordinary people against the elite		*unsettled mainstream parties that long dominated the political centre.*
Posit	verb	to put forward an idea as true so it can be discussed or tested	suggest, claim, assume	*The authors posit that rising sea temperatures, rather than overfishing, are the main driver of the decline in cod stocks.*
Purportedly	adverb	said to be true by some, but not proven	supposedly, reportedly, claimed to be	*The document, purportedly leaked from the ministry, has not yet been verified by officials.*
Reiterate	verb	to say something again for emphasis	repeat, restate	*The minister reiterated the need for unity.*
Replicate	verb	to repeat a study or test to check if the result is the same	repeat, copy, redo	*Other labs failed to replicate the original findings, raising doubts about the claim.*
Rhetoric	noun	persuasive (often empty) language in speech	oratory, talk	*The campaign was full of fiery rhetoric but few real plans.*
Tacit	adjective	understood without being said	implied, unspoken	*The deal had the tacit approval of the leadership.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Vow	verb/noun	to promise firmly	promise, pledge	*The minister vowed to complete the project by next year.*

⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Ardent		very enthusiastic/passionate	fervent, zealous, eager, keen	
Daunt	verb	to make someone lose courage	scare, discourage, worry	*The sheer scale of the reforms did not daunt the young administrators leading the project.*
Galvanise	verb	to shock or excite someone into action	spur, stir	*The disaster galvanised the public into demanding reform.*
Inert	adjective	lacking energy or the will to act	still, lifeless, inactive	*Civil society cannot remain inert while basic freedoms are being eroded.*
Invigorate		to give energy to	energise, refresh, revitalise, stimulate	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Kinetic	adjective	full of active movement and energy	moving, active, lively	*The minister promised a more kinetic foreign policy that responds quickly to events in the neighbourhood.*
Lassitude	noun	a feeling of tiredness and lack of energy or interest	tiredness, weariness, dullness	*A sense of policy lassitude has gripped the bureaucracy, with key reforms gathering dust for years.*
Lethargic		Lacking energy.	Sluggish, Lazy, Listless, Languid	
Lethargy	noun	a lack of energy or enthusiasm	tiredness, sluggishness	*Economic lethargy gripped the region for years.*
Mobilise	verb	to organise and bring people together for a cause or action	rally, gather, stir up	*Activists used encrypted apps to mobilise thousands of protesters within hours of the announcement.*
Obsequious	adjective	too eager to please / overly obedient	servile	*His obsequious manner annoyed his colleagues.*
Pugnacious		eager to fight/argue	combative, belligerent, aggressive, bellicose	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Pusillanimous	adjective	cowardly, lacking courage	cowardly	*Opponents accused the government of a pusillanimous response.*
Tepid	adjective	showing little enthusiasm; lukewarm	lukewarm, half-hearted	*The plan met with a tepid response from voters.*
Truculent	adjective	aggressive and eager to argue	hostile, fighting	*The minister gave a truculent reply to the press.*
Vibrant		Full of energy / colour.	Lively, Energetic, Dynamic, Spirited	
Voracious	adjective	wanting a very large amount; very greedy or eager	greedy, hungry, eager	*The city's voracious demand for water has drained the surrounding rivers dry.*
Zeal	noun	great energy or enthusiasm	passion, fervour	*Reformers pursued change with great zeal.*
Zealous	adjective	showing great energy and strong eagerness for a cause	eager, keen, passionate	*Overly zealous enforcement of the rules has frightened away honest small investors.*

🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Assess	verb	to judge the value, size, or quality of something	judge, check, rate	*The World Bank assessed the damage from the floods at over two billion dollars.*
Benchmark	noun	a standard level used to measure or compare performance	standard, marker, reference point	*The fund failed to beat its benchmark index for the third year running.*
Discern	verb	to notice or understand something clearly	notice, see, judge	*It is hard to discern any real change in policy beyond the government's bold announcements.*
Gauge	verb/noun	to measure or judge	measure, assess	*The survey tried to gauge public opinion.*
Probe	noun/verb	an investigation	inquiry, examination	*A probe has been ordered into the bridge collapse.*
Quantify	verb	to measure or express something as a number	measure, count, calculate	*The study sought to quantify the economic cost of air pollution.*
Scrutinise		To look at very closely.	Examine, Inspect, Investigate, Scan	
spec/spect		see/look	inspect, spectator, suspect, prospect	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Yardstick	noun	a standard used for comparison	measure, benchmark	*Literacy is a key yardstick of development.*

🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abrogate	verb	to officially cancel a law or agreement	cancel, end, scrap	*The state cannot abrogate fundamental rights even during an emergency.*
Accede	verb	To agree to a demand after pressure; also to formally join a treaty or take high office	agree, accept, join	*The government acceded to the rebels' demands for a power-sharing deal.*
Accord	noun	a formal agreement between countries or sides	agreement, deal, pact	*The peace accord ended thirty years of armed conflict.*
Aggregate	adjective	combined or added together into one total	total, combined, whole	*The aggregate effect of small savings across millions of homes was huge.*
co-/con-		with/together	cooperate, connect, coexist	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
co/con		together/with	cooperate, connect, collaborate, contract	
Coalesce	verb	to come together and form one group or whole	unite, join, merge	*Several small farmer unions coalesced into a single body to press their demands.*
Coalition	noun	a group of parties or people working together	alliance, union	*A fragile coalition government took power after the election.*
Cohesion	noun	the state of sticking together or unity	unity, togetherness	*The crisis tested the cohesion of the alliance.*
Cohesive	adjective	well united and working closely together	united, joined, together	*A cohesive opposition could pose a real challenge to the ruling party in the next election.*
Compatible	adjective	able to exist or work well together	matching, suited, fitting	*The reforms must be compatible with the country's wider development goals.*
Compliance	noun	the act of obeying a rule or law	obeying, following, agreement	*Many factories were shut down for non-compliance with the new pollution norms.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Conference NEW	noun	act of consulting together formally		*We were just outside the east German city of Erfurt, one of several groups setting up roadblocks to try to stop delegates from reaching the far-right Alternative für Deutschland (AfD) party conference.*
Consensus	noun	general agreement among a group	agreement, accord	*Members failed to reach a consensus on the new policy.*
Convene	verb	to call people together for a meeting	gather, meet, call together	*The Speaker convened an emergency session of Parliament to discuss the flood crisis.*
Converge	verb	to come together from different directions to one point	meet, join, come together	*Thousands of protesters converged on the state capital to demand higher wages.*
Cumulative	adjective	increasing by being added together step by step	growing, adding up, total	*The cumulative effect of small yearly emissions has been a sharp rise in sea levels.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Discordant	adjective	not in agreement; clashing	clashing, conflicting, mismatched	*The two datasets gave discordant results on rainfall trends.*
Disparate	adjective	made up of very different things that don't normally go together	different, varied, mixed	*The protest movement united disparate groups, from students to farmers, behind a single demand.*
Multilateral	adjective	involving many countries acting together	many-sided, group, joint	*The crisis can only be solved through a multilateral effort backed by the UN.*
Persuade		To make someone agree.	Convince, Coax, Cajole, Win over	
Ratification	noun	The official approval that makes a treaty or agreement legally binding	approval, sign-off, confirmation	*The trade pact awaits ratification by all twelve member parliaments.*
Reconcile	verb	to restore friendly relations; to make agree	settle, harmonise	*It is hard to reconcile growth with environmental care.*
Stipulate	verb	to state a clear condition in an agreement	specify, require	*The contract stipulates a strict deadline.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
uni		one	unite, unique, universe, unicorn	
Unilateral	adjective	done by one country alone, without agreement from others	one-sided, alone, solo	*Critics called the unilateral airstrikes a dangerous break from allied policy.*

⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Anticipation	noun	act of anticipating, taking up, placing, or considering something beforehand, or before the proper time in natural order	expectingness	*It turns every Palestinian mother into someone who lives in constant anticipation of loss.*
Ascertain	verb	to find out something for certain	find out, confirm, check	*Inspectors worked to ascertain the cause of the collapse.*
Endemic	adjective	regularly found in a certain place or group; a constant, settled presence	always present, native, built-in	*Corruption had become endemic in the country's police force.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Incumbent	noun/adjective	the person currently holding an office; also a duty placed on someone	sitting leader, current holder, duty	*The incumbent chief minister faces strong anti-establishment sentiment ahead of the polls.*
Ineluctable	adjective	impossible to avoid	unavoidable	*Reform became an ineluctable necessity.*
Inevitable	adjective	certain to happen, unavoidable	unavoidable, certain	*Some job losses were inevitable after the merger.*
Insurrection	noun	a violent uprising against authority or the state	revolt, uprising, rebellion	*Leaders of the failed insurrection were charged with treason.*
Mandate	noun/verb	official order or authority to act	order, authority	*The new government claimed a strong mandate from voters.*
Onus	noun	responsibility or duty for something	burden, duty	*The onus is on the company to prove its product is safe.*
Paramount	adjective	more important than anything else	supreme, chief	*Public safety must be of paramount importance.*
Predominant	adjective	the most common or strongest	main, leading, chief	*Coal remains the predominant source of power in several economies.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Propensity	noun	a natural tendency to behave in a certain way	tendency, habit, leaning	*The report noted the agency's propensity to delay action until a crisis erupts.*
Random	adjective	chosen by chance, with no set order or pattern	by chance, mixed, unplanned	*In a random trial, half the patients were given the drug and half a placebo.*
Remit	noun	The area of authority or the set of tasks a person or body is responsible for	duty, scope, job	*Climate policy falls outside the central bank's official remit.*
Tariff	noun	a tax placed on goods coming into a country	import tax, duty, charge	*Washington imposed steep tariffs on imported steel, angering its trading partners.*
Vaccination	noun	Inoculation with a vaccine, in order to protect from a particular disease or strain of disease		*A shot at life, Mandsaur's model for HPV vaccination This district in Madhya Pradesh has demonstrated effective grassroots strategies for HPV vaccination delivery*

🌫 Hidden, Unclear & Secret ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abstruse		hard to understand	obscure, recondite, esoteric, complex	
Arcane		secret, mysterious	mysterious, cryptic, esoteric, obscure	
Belie	verb	to give a false idea; to hide the truth	hide, mask, disguise	*The calm figures in the report belie the deep distress in rural households.*
Clandestine	adjective	done secretly, especially something illegal or sneaky	secret, hidden, undercover	*Investigators uncovered a clandestine programme to enrich uranium.*
Confound	verb	to confuse results by mixing in a hidden cause	confuse, muddle, mislead	*Smoking may confound the link between coffee and heart disease.*
Cryptic		having a hidden meaning	enigmatic, obscure, mysterious, ambiguous	
Dissemble		to hide true feelings/intent	disguise, feign, mask, pretend	
Divulge	verb	to reveal secret information	reveal, tell, share	*Officials refused to divulge the names of the firms under*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				investigation for tax fraud.
Esoteric	adjective	understood by only a few experts	specialised, obscure	*The debate turned into an esoteric discussion few followed.*
Furtive		Done secretly to avoid notice.	Secret, Stealthy, Sneaky, Clandestine	
Latent	adjective	existing but not yet visible or active	hidden, dormant	*The policy exposed latent tensions in society.*
Machination	noun	a secret clever plan to do something harmful	scheme, plot, trick	*The Opposition accused ruling parties of political machinations to topple the state government.*
Recondite		little known, obscure	abstruse, esoteric, arcane, profound	
Transparent		Transparent (light passes through) ↔ opaque (light does not).		
Underlying	adjective	hidden beneath the surface; the real cause behind something	hidden, basic, root	*The study aimed to find the underlying cause of the recurring infections.*
Veneer	noun	a thin, often false, outer appearance	facade, cover	*Behind the veneer of calm lay deep anxiety.*

🧱 Real, Concrete & Practical ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Authentic		True and original, not fake.	Genuine, Real, Bona fide, Legitimate	
bona fide	adjective	genuine; real and sincere, not fake	genuine, real, honest	*Only bona fide refugees qualify for the protection scheme.*
Empirical	adjective	based on real observation, testing, or experience - not just on ideas or guessing	tested, observed, real-world	*The study offers empirical evidence that early schooling improves later income, drawn from data on 50,000 children.*
Germane	adjective	closely connected and relevant to the topic	related, relevant, fitting	*The judge ruled that the old records were germane to the present case.*
Illusory	adjective	based on something false; not real	false, fake, unreal	*Promises of overnight prosperity are illusory and only deepen public disappointment.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Ontological	adjective	about the nature of being - what things really are, or whether they exist at all	about existence, about what is real	*Philosophers raised ontological questions about whether a digital mind could truly be said to exist.*
Ostensible	adjective	appearing true on the surface, but maybe not real	apparent, so-called	*The ostensible reason for the visit was trade.*
Perfunctory	adjective	done quickly without real care	careless, half-hearted	*The inquiry was perfunctory and ignored key facts.*
Pertinent	adjective	relevant and to the point	relevant, apt	*She raised several pertinent questions in the debate.*
Robust	adjective	strong and healthy	strong, sturdy	*The country posted robust economic growth.*
Tangible	adjective	real and able to be clearly seen or felt	real, concrete	*The talks produced no tangible results.*
Travesty	noun	a bad and unfair copy or example that insults the real thing	mockery, joke, insult	*Denying the accused a lawyer was called a travesty of justice by the high court.*

✊ Reject, Revenge & Force ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abandon		To abandon = to give up or forsake.	Forsake	
Annexation	noun	when one country takes over and adds another's land to its own by force	takeover, seizing land, grabbing	*Most UN members refused to recognise the annexation of the peninsula in 2014.*
Capitulate	verb	to give up / surrender	surrender	*The company refused to capitulate to the demands.*
Cede	verb	to give up power or territory	surrender, yield	*The party refused to cede control of the council.*
Coup	noun	a sudden, often violent, seizure of government power	takeover, overthrow, power grab	*The military staged a coup and detained the elected leaders overnight.*
Defy	verb	to openly refuse to obey something	disobey, resist, ignore	*Thousands of farmers continued to defy the ban and marched towards the capital.*
Depose	verb	To remove a ruler or leader from power, often by force	overthrow, remove, topple	*The general was deposed in a bloodless coup and fled abroad.*
Forfeit	verb	to lose a right or possession as a penalty	lose, give up	*Defaulters may forfeit their deposits.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
ject		throw	reject, eject, project, inject	
Reprisal	noun	an act of revenge or retaliation	retaliation, revenge	*Witnesses stayed silent for fear of reprisal.*
Repudiate		to reject/deny	reject, disown, renounce, disavow	
Spurn	verb	to reject with contempt	reject, refuse	*The offer was spurned by union leaders.*
Usurp	verb	to take power or a position by force, without the right	seize, grab, take over	*Critics warned that the ordinance allowed the executive to usurp powers meant for Parliament.*
Vindictive		seeking revenge	vengeful, spiteful, rancorous, unforgiving	
Wrest	verb	to take something by force or effort	seize, grab	*The opposition wrested control of three states.*

⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Approximate	adjective	close to but not exactly correct	rough, near, close	*The report gave an approximate figure for*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				global carbon emissions.
Belated	adjective	coming later than it should	late, overdue	*The government offered a belated apology to the victims.*
Concise		Short and clear.	Brief, Succinct, Terse, Pithy	
Ephemeral	adjective	lasting a very short time	short-lived	*Online fame is often ephemeral.*
Harbinger	noun	a sign of something to come	omen, forerunner	*Falling sales were a harbinger of recession.*
Imminent	adjective	about to happen very soon	impending, near	*Forecasters warned of an imminent cyclone along the coast.*
Indelible		impossible to remove	permanent, ineradicable, lasting, fixed	
Loom	verb	to appear close and threatening; about to happen	approach, threaten, near	*A severe water crisis looms over several cities this summer.*
Looming	adjective	approaching and threatening	impending, approaching	*Businesses are worried about a looming recession.*
Methodology	noun	the set of methods used to do research	method, approach, procedure	*Critics questioned the study's methodology*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				and small sample size.
Provisional	adjective	for now only; likely to be changed later	temporary, for now, not final	*The provisional figures suggest a record harvest, but they may be revised.*
Stopgap	noun/adjective	a temporary fix used until a proper solution is found	temporary fix, makeshift, quick patch	*Critics dismissed the cash handout as a stopgap that ignored the deeper crisis of rural unemployment.*
Sustainable	adjective	able to continue for a long time without using up resources or harming the planet	lasting, green, long-term	*The UN's Sustainable Development Goals aim to end poverty by 2030 without damaging the environment.*
Transient		Lasting a short time.	Temporary, Fleeting, Brief, Momentary	

🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Beguile		to charm/deceive	charm, captivate, enchant; trick, dupe	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Chicanery	noun	clever trickery to deceive	trickery, cheating	*Voters were warned against electoral chicanery.*
Deceive		To trick / fool.	Cheat, Mislead, Dupe, Defraud	
Duplicitous		two-faced, deceptive	deceitful, double-dealing, dishonest	
Fabricate		To make up something false.	Invent, Concoct, Falsify, Forge	
Forge	verb	to build or create (a bond); to fake	build, create	*The two nations forged a new trade partnership.*
Gambit	noun	a clever first move made to gain an advantage	move, trick, plan	*The early announcement of welfare schemes was seen as a political gambit before the polls.*
Histrionic	adjective	overly dramatic and fake in showing feelings	dramatic, fake, showy	*The histrionic walkout in Parliament drew cameras but solved nothing.*
Mendacious	adjective	lying, not telling the truth	dishonest, false	*The report was dismissed as mendacious propaganda.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Prevaricate	verb	to avoid telling the truth directly; to speak in a misleading way	dodge, mislead, evade	*Instead of owning the failure, officials chose to prevaricate, blaming everyone but themselves.*
Sanctimonious	adjective	acting as if you are morally better than others in a fake way	preachy, self-righteous, smug	*The editorial mocked the sanctimonious tone of leaders who themselves flouted the rules.*
Spurious	adjective	fake, not genuine	false, fake	*The market was flooded with spurious medicines.*

 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Conundrum		a confusing problem/riddle	puzzle, riddle, enigma, dilemma	
Extricate		to free from difficulty	disentangle, release, free, liberate	
Flaw	noun	a fault or weakness that makes something not perfect	fault, weakness, defect	*Experts pointed out a basic flaw in the design of the new policy.*
Grapple	verb	to struggle hard to deal with a problem	struggle, fight, handle	*States continue to grapple with rising*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				unemployment among the youth.
Grievance	noun	a complaint about unfair treatment	complaint, problem, grudge	*The protesters said the government had ignored their long-standing grievances.*
Heuristic	noun	a quick rule of thumb that helps you solve a problem fast, even if not perfectly	shortcut, rough rule, quick method	*Investors often rely on a simple heuristic rather than analysing every data point.*
Hurdle	noun	a problem or difficulty that must be solved	problem, barrier, obstacle	*Poor road connectivity remains the biggest hurdle to rural growth.*
Immaculate		Perfectly clean / without fault.	Spotless, Flawless, Pristine, Pure	
Persist	verb	to continue firmly despite difficulty	continue, last, remain	*Unemployment is likely to persist unless new industries are set up.*
Procrastinate		To keep putting off work.	Delay, Postpone, Defer, Dawdle	
Respite		a short rest from difficulty	break, relief, breather, reprieve	
Sanguine	adjective	hopeful and positive even in difficulty	optimistic, hopeful	*Economists remain sanguine about next year's growth.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Setback	noun	a problem that delays or stops progress	delay, problem, blow	*The project suffered a major setback after the central funds were withheld.*
Tackle	verb	to deal with a difficult problem	handle, face, deal with	*The state has launched a fresh drive to tackle child malnutrition.*

🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Causation	noun	the relationship where one thing directly causes another	cause, link, reason	*Correlation does not prove causation, the authors cautioned.*
Cite	verb	to mention something as a reason or proof	mention, quote, point to	*The court cited the right to privacy while striking down the surveillance order.*
Deliberate	adjective/verb	done on purpose; or to think carefully before deciding	planned, intended, discuss	*The committee will deliberate for two weeks before announcing its final decision.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Ergo	adverb	therefore; for that reason (sounds formal or logical)	therefore, so, thus	*Supply fell while demand rose; ergo, prices climbed.*
Factor	noun	one thing that helps cause or shape a result	cause, reason, part	*Diet and exercise were the two biggest factors linked to a longer life.*
flect/flex		bend	reflect, flexible, deflect, inflection	
Hence	adverb	for this reason; therefore	so, therefore, that is why	*Costs rose sharply; hence the steep increase in ticket prices.*
Infer	verb	to work out a conclusion from the evidence	conclude, work out, gather	*From the fossil record, scientists infer that the climate was once far warmer.*
Mull	verb	to think about carefully	consider	*The cabinet is mulling a new tax on luxury cars.*
Reckon	verb	to think or consider; to deal with	believe, calculate	*Analysts reckon growth will slow next year.*
Wanton	adjective	deliberate and without reason or care	reckless, needless	*The report described wanton destruction of forests.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Warrant	verb	to be a good enough reason for something; to deserve	deserve, justify, need	*The scale of the tragedy warrants an independent inquiry, not a quiet internal review.*

⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Candid	adjective	honest and direct in speaking	honest, frank, open	*In a candid interview, the chief minister admitted the policy had failed.*
Corruption	noun	act of corrupting or of impairing integrity, virtue, or moral principle	destroying, ruining, spoiling	*Fragmented accountability: On the Taratala warehouse collapse in Kolkata Corruption at all levels takes a toll on lives at construction sites*
cred		believe	credit, credible, incredible, credentials	
Devout		deeply religious / sincere	pious, devoted, reverent, dedicated	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Dubious	adjective	doubtful, possibly not honest or true	doubtful, shady, unsure	*The company's dubious accounting practices finally drew the attention of investigators.*
Egalitarian	adjective	believing everyone should be equal and treated the same	equal, fair, level	*The Nordic model is often praised as egalitarian, with policies designed to keep the gap between rich and poor small.*
Equitable	adjective	fair and just to all	fair, just	*Activists demanded a more equitable sharing of resources.*
Forthright		direct and honest	candid, frank, blunt, straightforward	
Holistic	adjective	looking at the whole thing, not just separate parts	whole, complete, all-round	*The Lancet review recommended a holistic approach to health that includes housing and clean water.*
Limpid		clear and transparent	clear, lucid, pellucid, crystalline	
Lucid		Easy to understand.	Clear, Coherent, Intelligible, Transparent	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Marginal	adjective	very small; only just big enough to notice	tiny, slight, small	*The vaccine showed only a marginal benefit in older patients, the researchers cautioned.*
Normative	adjective	about how things should be, not just how they are - based on rules or values	about what is right, value-based, should-based	*The paper shifts from describing inequality to making a normative claim that it must be reduced.*
Obfuscation	noun	deliberately making something confusing to hide the truth	confusion, cover-up, blurring	*The minister's reply was a masterclass in obfuscation, dodging every pointed question.*
Paradox	noun	something that seems to contradict itself but may still be true	contradiction, puzzle, strange truth	*The study highlights the paradox of choice: more options can leave people less happy.*
Pellucid		very clear / easy to understand	lucid, transparent, limpid, crystal-clear	
Systemic	adjective	affecting a whole system, not just one part; built into how things work	system-wide, deep-rooted, whole-system	*The crash exposed systemic weaknesses in the global banking system.*
Veracious		truthful	honest, truthful, accurate, candid	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Veracity	noun	truthfulness; accuracy	root VER=truth; honesty	*The court questioned the veracity of the witness.*
Verify	verb	to check that something is true	root VER=truth; confirm	*Officials verify each document before approval.*
Warranted	adjective	justified by the facts; reasonable	justified, fair, deserved	*Given the rising case numbers, stricter travel rules now appear warranted.*

Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Acrimony	noun	bitter, angry feelings between people	bitterness	*The talks ended in acrimony with no deal.*
Animosity		strong hostility	hostility, antagonism, enmity, hatred	
Backlash	noun	a strong, angry reaction from many people against something	anger, protest, reaction	*The sudden hike in toll charges triggered a sharp backlash from commuters across the highway.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Divisive	adjective	causing people to split into hostile groups	splitting, dividing, separating	*The leader was criticised for making divisive remarks ahead of the elections.*
Hostile		Showing strong dislike / enmity.	Unfriendly, Antagonistic, Aggressive, Belligerent	
Inimical	adjective	harmful or hostile to something	harmful, against	*Such policies are inimical to small traders.*
mal		bad	malice, malevolent, malfunction, malign	
Mollify	verb	to make someone less angry; to calm them down	calm, soothe, soften	*The government cut fuel taxes to mollify the protesting transport unions.*
Notwithstanding	preposition	in spite of; despite	despite, even with, regardless of	*Notwithstanding the funding cuts, the laboratory completed its trials on schedule.*
Placate	verb	to calm someone who is angry	pacify, soothe	*The minister tried to placate angry protesters.*
Provoke	verb	to deliberately make someone angry or cause a reaction	root VOKE=call forth; incite	*The remarks provoked protests across the city.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Rancour		bitter resentment	bitterness, animosity, enmity, malice	
Recalcitrant	adjective	stubbornly refusing to obey	defiant, stubborn	*A few recalcitrant states blocked the reform.*
Virulent		extremely harmful/hostile	poisonous, venomous, deadly, hostile	
Vituperative	adjective	full of bitter, abusive criticism	harshly critical	*The campaign turned vituperative in its final week.*

👑 Power, Control & Influence ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abide	verb	to accept and follow a rule or decision	follow, obey, accept	*The court made it clear that all parties must abide by its order, irrespective of their political differences.*
Adhere	verb	to stick to or strictly follow a rule	stick, follow, keep to	*Banks have been told to adhere to the new lending norms issued by the Reserve Bank of India.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Autonomy	noun	the right of a region to govern its own affairs	self-rule, independence, freedom	*The province was promised greater autonomy in return for laying down arms.*
Capacity	noun	the ability or resources to do something	ability, power, room	*The programme aims to build local capacity so communities can manage their own water supply.*
Clout	noun	power or influence to affect decisions	power, influence, weight	*The trade body still carries enormous clout in shaping export policy.*
Democracy	noun	Rule by the people, especially as a form of government	democratism	*Yes and no: On the erosion of India's grassroots democracy Gram sabhas must have the right to give or withhold consent*
Disenfranchise	verb	to take away someone's right to vote or their power in society	silence, exclude, strip rights	*Critics argued that the new voter-ID law would disenfranchise millions of poor and rural citizens who lacked formal documents.*
Flout	verb	to openly break or ignore a rule	break, ignore, defy	*Builders who flout safety norms must face strict*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				penalties, the editorial argued.
flu/flux		flow	fluent, influence, fluid, influx	
Oust	verb	to force someone out of power	remove, throw out	*The party voted to oust its own leader.*
Wield	verb	to hold and use power or a tool	exercise, hold	*The committee wields great influence over policy.*

😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Assuage		to ease/soothe	relieve, soothe, alleviate, mollify	
Buoyant	adjective	cheerful or economically strong	lively, upbeat	*The market stayed buoyant despite the bad news.*
Disenchant	verb	to make someone lose hope or trust	disillusion, sour	*Many young voters feel disenchanted with politics.*
Forbearance	noun	the quality of being patient and self-	patience, calm, restraint	*The Opposition praised the Speaker's forbearance during the*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		controlled, especially when others test you		*stormy debate in Parliament.*
Genial		cheerful and friendly	affable, cordial, amiable, warm	
Implacable	adjective	impossible to calm or satisfy	root PLAC=please + IM=not; unyielding	*He faced implacable opposition from the unions.*
Jovial		Full of fun and good humour.	Cheerful, Merry, Jolly, Convivial	
Jubilant	adjective	feeling and showing great joy	very happy, joyful, cheerful	*Party workers were jubilant after the surprise win, but the editorial urged them to focus on governance instead.*
Lull	noun/verb	a quiet or calm period	pause, calm	*There was a brief lull in the fighting.*
Nonchalant	adjective	calm and not worried, showing no concern	casual, cool, unbothered	*The officials seemed nonchalant about the rising debt, brushing aside the warnings.*
Phlegmatic		calm, unemotional	composed, placid, stolid, imperturbable	
Quixotic	adjective	unrealistic and impractical in a hopeful	unrealistic, dreamy	*His quixotic plan to end all poverty won few*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		way		*backers.*

🌑 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Adverse	adjective	harmful or unfavourable	bad, harmful, negative	*Experts warned of the adverse effects of rising prices on poor families.*
Aftermath	noun	the situation after a bad event	consequences, fallout	*Thousands were left homeless in the aftermath of the flood.*
Boorish		rough and bad-mannered	uncouth, crude, loutish, vulgar	
Brazen	adjective	bold and shameless	shameless, bold	*The brazen theft happened in broad daylight.*
Breed	verb	to cause something, usually something bad, to develop	cause, create, produce	*Delays in justice only breed anger and distrust among ordinary citizens.*
Egregious	adjective	extremely bad, shockingly wrong	terrible	*The audit revealed egregious misuse of public funds.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Flagrant	adjective	clearly and openly bad; shocking	obvious, shocking, open	*The demolition was a flagrant violation of the court's stay order.*
Galvanic	adjective	giving a sudden shock that makes people act	shocking, exciting, rousing	*The verdict had a galvanic effect on activists, who took to the streets within hours.*
Glaring	adjective	very obvious and bad; easy to notice	obvious, clear, plain	*The audit exposed glaring lapses in the way relief funds were distributed during the floods.*
Harrowing	adjective	very distressing and painful to experience	painful, scary, shocking	*Survivors gave harrowing accounts of the night the floods swept their village.*
Heinous	adjective	extremely wicked or shocking	evil, terrible, cruel	*The court called the attack one of the most heinous crimes the city had witnessed.*
Impudent		boldly disrespectful	impertinent, insolent, brazen, cheeky	
Iniquity	noun	great injustice or wickedness	wrong, evil, unfairness	*The court called the bonded-labour system a gross iniquity that*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				shames a modern democracy.
mal-		bad	malfunction, malnutrition, maltreat	
Malignant		very harmful / spiteful	virulent, deadly, malevolent, cancerous	
mis-		wrong/bad	misunderstand, misguide, misuse	
Notorious	adjective	famous for something bad	infamous, well-known	*The area is notorious for its high crime rate.*
Noxious		poisonous, harmful	toxic, poisonous, harmful, deadly	
Ominous	adjective	suggesting something bad will happen	threatening, sinister	*There were ominous signs of an economic slowdown.*
Petulant		childishly bad-tempered	sulky, peevish, irritable, querulous	
Repercussion	noun	an indirect, usually bad, consequence	consequence, fallout	*The decision had serious economic repercussions.*
Surly		bad-tempered, unfriendly	sullen, grumpy, churlish, gruff	
Tantamount	adjective	equal to; the same as (something bad)	equal to, the same as, as good as	*Silence from the leadership, the writer*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				said, is tantamount to approving the violence.

📦 Amount, Size & Plenty ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Abound	verb	to exist in large numbers; to be plenty	fill, swarm, overflow	*Rumours abound in the city ahead of the crucial state elections next month.*
Abundant		Abundant = existing in large quantities = plentiful.	Plentiful	
Ample	adjective	more than enough; plenty	enough, plenty, large	*The government claims it has ample reserves of food grains to manage any crisis.*
Average	noun	the middle or typical amount, found by adding values and dividing	typical, middle, mean	*On average, patients recovered two days faster with the new treatment.*
Copious		abundant, plentiful	abundant, profuse, ample, bountiful	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Decimate		to destroy a large part	devastate, ravage, annihilate, wipe out	
Deficient	adjective	not having enough of something needed	lacking, short, missing	*Rural health centres remain deficient in both doctors and basic medicines.*
Exodus	noun	a large number of people leaving a place	departure, flight, outflow	*The lockdown triggered a massive exodus of migrant workers from the big cities.*
Exorbitant	adjective	far too high in price or amount	costly, steep, excessive	*Patients complained of exorbitant fees charged by private hospitals during the crisis.*
Grandiose	adjective	too large or showy in plan, often more impressive in words than in reality	showy, huge, over-the-top	*The minister's grandiose promise of smart cities remains far from reality in most districts.*
Hefty	adjective	large in amount, size, or weight	large, heavy	*The court imposed a hefty fine on the firm.*
Increasingly	adverb	Increasing in amount or intensity	more and more	*But it’s increasingly likely that they will face some kind of hostility there.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
magn		great/large	magnify, magnificent, magnitude, magnate	
Magnitude	noun	the size or scale of something	size, scale, amount	*The magnitude of the temperature rise surprised even the most senior climate scientists.*
Meagre	adjective	very small in amount; inadequate	scanty, poor	*Workers earn a meagre wage for long hours.*
Measure	verb	to find out the size, amount, or level of something	check, count, size up	*The team used satellites to measure the rate of ice loss in Antarctica.*
Myriad	noun/adjective	a very large number	countless, many	*The reform faces a myriad of challenges.*
Paucity	noun	a shortage or very small amount of something	shortage, lack, scarcity	*The paucity of reliable data has made it nearly impossible to gauge the scheme's real impact.*
Plausible	adjective	believable; reasonable enough to be true	believable, likely, reasonable	*The authors offer a plausible explanation for the sudden fall in cases.*
Plethora		an over-abundance	excess, surplus, glut, profusion	
Profuse		given/produced in plenty	abundant, lavish, copious, prolific	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Redundant		not needed, excess	superfluous, surplus, unnecessary	
Significant	adjective	large or important enough to matter, especially in results	important, large, notable	*The drop in infections was statistically significant, the Lancet study reported.*
Substantial	adjective	large in size or amount; clearly important	big, large, sizeable	*The report called for a substantial increase in funding for rural clinics.*
super-/sur-		above/over	superman, supervise, surplus, surface	
Superfluous		more than needed	excessive, redundant, surplus, unneeded	
Surfeit		an excess, too much	glut, surplus, overabundance, excess	
Surplus	noun	the extra amount left when income is more than spending	extra, leftover, spare amount	*Germany ran a large trade surplus, exporting far more than it bought from abroad.*
Yield	verb	to produce or give a result or amount	produce, give, return	*The new farming method yielded twenty percent more grain per acre.*

⚖ Difference, Comparison & Opposite ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Antithesis	noun	the exact opposite	opposite	*His calm style was the antithesis of his rival's.*
Control	noun	a group in a test that gets no treatment, used to compare results	comparison group, baseline	*Compared with the control group, the treated patients showed clear improvement.*
Converse	noun	the opposite of a statement; the reverse	opposite, reverse, flip side	*The data show that wealth improves health, but the converse — that good health builds wealth — also holds.*
de jure	adjective	existing by law; official, on paper (the opposite of de facto)	by law, officially, legally	*De jure the regions are equal, but funding tells a different story.*
Dwarf	verb	to make something else look small in comparison	outsize, overshadow, beat	*This year's defence budget dwarfs the amount set aside for public health and education combined.*
Exemplary		serving as a perfect model	model, ideal, commendable, admirable	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Generous		"Generous" means giving freely; its opposite is "stingy," meaning unwilling to give or spend.		
Juxtapose	verb	to place side by side for comparison	contrast, compare	*The article juxtaposes wealth and poverty.*
Paradigm	noun	a typical model or pattern of doing something	model, pattern	*Remote work has caused a paradigm shift in offices.*
Paragon		a model of excellence	exemplar, ideal, model, paradigm	
Trend	noun	the general direction in which something is changing over time	pattern, direction, drift	*The report highlights a worrying upward trend in youth unemployment across the region.*

📥 Catch, Hold & Seize ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
cap/cept		take	capture, accept, receive, capable	
Captivate		To attract and hold attention.	Charm, Enchant, Fascinate, Mesmerise	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Elusive	adjective	hard to find, catch, or achieve	hard to catch, slippery, tricky	*Despite years of policy reform, lasting peace in the region remains elusive.*
Nab	verb	to catch or arrest	catch, arrest	*Police nabbed two suspects near the border.*
ten/tain		hold	tenant, retain, contain, tenacious	

📌 Cause, Effect & Consequence ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Annul	verb	To officially cancel a law, contract, or result so it no longer counts	cancel, void, scrap	*The court annulled the election results after evidence of widespread fraud.*
Contentious	adjective	likely to cause disagreement	controversial, disputed	*The contentious bill divided lawmakers sharply.*
Corollary	noun	a result or fact that naturally follows from something already proven	natural result, follow-on, knock-on point	*A corollary of rising sea levels is the loss of low-lying farmland.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Engender	verb	to cause or produce a feeling or situation	cause, create, produce	*Transparent governance can engender greater confidence among ordinary citizens.*
Experience	noun	effect upon the judgment or feelings produced by any event, whether witnessed or participated in		*Given that Keir Starmer's resignation came after a mutiny within his own government over inadequate defence spending, some may view Burnham's lack of direct defence experience as a worrying liability.*
Incendiary	adjective	likely to cause anger or violence	fiery, inflaming, provoking	*Leaders must avoid incendiary speeches that can ignite communal tensions overnight.*
Margin of error	noun	the small range a result may be off by	allowance, give-or-take, range	*The poll showed 52 percent support, with a margin of error of three points.*
Offset	verb	to balance out or cancel one effect with another	balance, cancel out, make up for	*Gains in solar power were offset by rising demand for air conditioning.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Outcome	noun	the result or effect that comes out of something	result, effect, end	*Better health outcomes were seen in regions with more clean drinking water.*
Outlier	noun	a result that is very different from all the others	odd one out, exception, stray result	*One outlier showed a huge effect, but the rest of the data was flat.*
Ramification	noun	A result or consequence of an action, often complex and far-reaching	consequence, result, effect	*Economists are still tracing the ramifications of the trade war.*
Thereby	adverb	by that means; as a result of that	so, thus, in that way	*The reforms cut paperwork and thereby freed doctors to see more patients.*
Thus	adverb	therefore; in this way; as a result	so, therefore, in this way	*Rainfall was poor; the harvest, thus, fell short of targets.*

⚠ Highest & Lowest Points ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Culminate	verb	to reach a final or highest point	end, climax	*Months of protests culminated in a mass strike.*
Heyday	noun	the time when something was most successful or powerful	peak, prime, best	*In its heyday, the textile hub employed thousands and powered the local economy.*
Nadir	noun	the lowest or worst point of something	lowest point, bottom, rock-bottom	*Relations between the two neighbours hit a nadir after the border clash last winter.*
Zenith	noun	the highest or most successful point	peak, top, height	*The movement reached its zenith when millions joined the march across the country.*

🍀 Luck, Chance & Fate ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Fortuitous	adjective	happening by lucky chance rather than by plan	lucky, chance, unplanned	*The timing of the rate cut was fortuitous, coming just as inflation began to cool.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Hapless	adjective	unlucky and unable to do anything about it	unlucky, helpless, poor	*Hapless commuters were left stranded for hours after the sudden transport strike.*

🗨 Talkative, Loud & Wordy ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Florid	adjective	too fancy or overly decorated in language	showy, fancy, flowery	*The minister's florid speech offered little in the way of concrete plans.*
Garrulous		talking too much, rambling	loquacious, chatty, voluble, talkative	
Grandiloquent		pompous, lofty in language	bombastic, pompous, magniloquent, florid	
Loquacious	adjective	talking a lot; very talkative	talkative, chatty, wordy	*The usually loquacious spokesman fell oddly silent when reporters raised the funding scandal.*
Turgid		swollen / pompously wordy	bloated, inflated, grandiloquent	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Vociferous	adjective	loud and strong in expressing opinions	loud, noisy, outspoken	*Vociferous protests outside Parliament forced the government to review the controversial clause.*

😢 Sadness, Regret & Complaint ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Contrite		feeling deep regret	remorseful, penitent, repentant, apologetic	
Lachrymose	adjective	tearful or causing tears; full of sadness	tearful, sad, weepy	*The editorial dismissed the leader's lachrymose appeal as a calculated bid for sympathy before the verdict.*
Lament	verb	to express deep sadness or regret about something	mourn, regret, grieve	*Editorials across the nation lamented the loss of the veteran journalist.*
Penitent		feeling sorrow for wrongs	contrite, repentant, remorseful, rueful	

Boldness, Recklessness & Daring ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Audacious	adjective	very bold and daring, sometimes shockingly so	bold, daring, fearless	*The startup's audacious plan to electrify every village bus fleet drew both praise and doubt.*
Headlong	adverb/adjective	rushing in fast without thinking	reckless, hasty, quick	*The headlong rush to privatise has left many safeguards behind.*
Impetuous	adjective	acting quickly without thinking	hasty, rash, sudden	*The government's impetuous decision to demonetise caught even its own officials by surprise.*
Intrepid		Showing no fear.	Fearless, Brave, Bold, Dauntless	

😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
circum		around	circumference, circumnavigate, circumspect	
Circumspect	adjective	cautious; considering all risks	root SPEC=look + CIRCUM=around; wary	*Banks turned circumspect after the market crash.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Diffident	adjective	shy and lacking confidence in oneself	shy, timid, unsure	*A diffident response from the regulator failed to reassure jittery markets.*
Dissolute		lacking moral restraint	debauched, depraved, licentious, decadent	
Licentious	adjective	behaving without moral restraint, especially in a sexual or lawless way	wild, immoral, unrestrained	*The film board defended its cuts, arguing the scenes were gratuitously licentious rather than artistic.*
Reluctant		Not wanting to do something.	Unwilling, Hesitant, Disinclined, Loath	
Reticent	adjective	unwilling to speak much or share one's thoughts	quiet, shy, silent	*The government was reticent about the real cost of the bailout package.*
Taciturn		saying very little	reticent, reserved, uncommunicative, tight-lipped	

□ Unity, Sameness & Division ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Cleave	verb	to split or divide sharply	split, divide, cut	*The new bill threatens to cleave the alliance along religious and regional lines.*
Concurrent	adjective	happening at the same time	at once, parallel, simultaneous	*The country faced concurrent crises of drought and debt.*
Consistent	adjective	staying the same; not changing from test to test	steady, even, dependable	*The results were consistent across all three independent laboratories.*
Demarcate	verb	to set or mark the boundaries or limits of something	mark out, set limits, divide	*The treaty sought to clearly demarcate the contested border that had triggered repeated clashes.*
Detachment	noun	a small group of troops sent on a separate task; also being emotionally distant	unit, small force, group	*A detachment of peacekeepers was stationed along the contested border.*
Discrete	adjective	separate and individually distinct	separate, distinct, apart	*Researchers identified four discrete stages in the disease's progression.*
Factional	adjective	relating to small rival groups inside a larger	split, in-fighting, group-vs-group	*Factional infighting paralysed the cabinet*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		party or movement		*just as the country faced its worst economic crisis in decades.*
fract/frag		break	fracture, fragment, fragile, fraction	
Homogeneous	adjective	made of parts that are all the same	same, uniform, alike	*India is far too diverse to be governed as a single homogeneous bloc.*
Partition	noun	the division of one country or land into separate parts	division, split, separation	*The partition of the colony left millions displaced across new borders.*
Polarisation	noun	when people split into two opposing groups with no middle ground	division, splitting, taking sides	*Researchers found that social media accelerates political polarisation by pushing users toward more extreme views.*
Polarise	verb	to split people into two opposing groups	divide, split, separate	*The new law threatens to polarise an already divided society along religious lines.*
Schism		a deep split/division	rift, division, rupture, breach	
Secession	noun	The act of a region formally breaking away	breakaway, split, separation	*The northern province's vote for secession*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		from a country to form its own		*alarmed neighbouring states.*

🛠️ Correct, Fix & Improve ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Ameliorate		to make better	improve, enhance, better, upgrade	
Quandary	noun	a difficult situation where it is hard to decide what to do	fix, confusion, hard choice	*The government faces a quandary between controlling prices and supporting struggling farmers.*
Rectify	verb	to correct something that is wrong	correct, fix, repair	*The board promised to rectify the accounting errors flagged by auditors.*
Redress	noun/verb	to correct or set right a wrong	fix, correct, make right	*Citizens deserve a swift mechanism to redress complaints against officials.*
Specious	adjective	looks correct but is actually false	misleading	*The argument was specious and fell apart under questioning.*

🪜 Use, Need & Involve ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Deplete	verb	to use up something until very little is left	use up, drain, empty	*Years of over-extraction have depleted the city's once-rich groundwater reserves.*
Entail	verb	to involve something as a necessary part	involve, require, need	*Reforming the power sector will entail tough choices that few governments enjoy making.*
Hinge	verb	to depend completely on something	depend, rely, rest	*The success of the scheme hinges on how quickly funds reach the districts.*

🚫 Useless, Hopeless & Empty ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Bombastic		high-sounding but empty	pompous, grandiose, inflated, turgid	
Futile	adjective	useless because it will not work	useless, pointless, vain	*Without real reform, such half-measures will*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				prove futile, the columnist warned.
vac		empty	vacant, vacuum, evacuate, vacation	

🧩 Complicated, Confusing & Vague ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Labyrinthine	adjective	extremely complicated and confusing, like a maze	complex, confusing, twisting	*Small traders complain that the labyrinthine tax-filing process drives them to expensive consultants they can ill afford.*

💥 Quality, Character & Behaviour ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Accidentally	adverb	In an accidental manner	casually, fortuitously	*Then he accidentally drops it in the sink.*
Architecturally	adverb	In an architectural manner		*They are surrounded by modern-looking housing developments – architecturally smart,*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				medium-rise, expensive-looking in their design.
Brusque		abrupt and rude in manner	curt, blunt, gruff, short	
duc/duct		lead	conduct, educate, induce, produce	
Eligibility NEW	noun	state, quality, or the fact of being eligible		*The court's ruling enabled her to make a fourth bid for the Élysée by reducing an eligibility ban to a length of time already served.*
Excruciatingly	adverb	In an excruciating manner or to an excruciating degree		*We have even, excruciatingly, seen a few American commentators attempt to use the word in conversation.*
Importance	noun	quality or condition of being important or worthy of note		*Tragic evening: On the earthquake in Venezuela Venezuela's quake holds lessons on the importance of preparedness*
Legitimacy	noun	the quality of being accepted as rightful and	rightfulness, acceptance, validity	*After the disputed count, the new government*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		lawful by the people		*struggled to establish its legitimacy in the eyes of voters.*
Mercurial	adjective	changing moods or behaviour quickly and unpredictably	moody, changing, unstable	*Investors remain wary of the mercurial policy shifts that have rattled markets twice this year.*

Other & Mixed ↑ top

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
a priori	adjective	based on reasoning or theory rather than on actual experience	in theory, beforehand, from reasoning	*There is no a priori reason to assume the trend will continue.*
Aberration		a departure from the norm	anomaly, deviation, oddity, abnormality	
Abscond		to flee secretly	flee, decamp, escape, run off	
Accelerate		To make faster.	Hasten, Expedite, Quicken, Speed up	
Accusation NEW	noun	act of accusing	allegation, assertion, censure	*Democrat Graham Platner suspends campaign for key US Senate race in Maine*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				The decision came days after a woman accused him of sexual assault, an accusation he says is "categorically false".
Acquiesce		to accept reluctantly	comply, consent, assent, concur	
ad hoc	adjective	made or done only for one purpose, right now, not planned in advance	for-this-only, on-the-spot, unplanned	*The UN set up an ad hoc committee to handle the sudden refugee crisis.*
Adjacent	adjective	lying next to something	next to, nearby, neighbouring	*Flooding affected the river and all adjacent farmland.*
Adolescent	noun	person who is in adolescence		*How schools can tackle adolescent malnutrition Physical inactivity must be treated as seriously as poor diet.*
Affable		friendly and easy to talk to	genial, amiable, cordial, congenial	
Affordable	adjective	Able to be afforded		*an affordable vacation in the local area*
Affront	noun	a rude act or insult that hurts pride	insult, offence, slight	*The minister's remark was seen as an affront*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				to the dignity of the farming community.
Agricultural	noun	product or commodity from agriculture		*Razor's edge: On the progress of the southwest monsoon High heat and low rainfall is threatening agricultural produce*
Albeit	conjunction	although; even though	though, even if, while	*Growth returned in the third quarter, albeit at a slower pace than hoped.*
Aloof		distant, unfriendly	detached, remote, standoffish, indifferent	
Altruistic		selflessly caring for others	selfless, unselfish, philanthropic, charitable	
am/amor		love	amiable, amorous, enamour, amity	
Ambivalent	adjective	having mixed feelings; pulled both ways	unsure, of two minds, mixed	*Voters appear deeply ambivalent about the reforms, supporting the goal but fearing the cost.*
Amiable		Pleasant and easy to like.	Friendly, Affable, Cordial, Genial	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Amity		friendly relations	friendship, harmony, goodwill, cordiality	
Ammunition NEW	noun	Articles used in charging firearms and ordnance of all kinds	ammo	*Starmer gifted gun and ammunition by Turkish president at Nato The weapon has not been brought back to the UK and has instead been left with British officials in Turkey.*
Analyse	verb	to study something carefully to understand its parts and meaning	study, examine, break down	*Scientists analysed blood samples from thousands of patients to find the pattern.*
ann/enn		year	annual, anniversary, biennial, perennial	
Annihilate	verb	to destroy something completely	wipe out, destroy, crush	*Commanders warned that nuclear weapons could annihilate entire cities.*
Anomaly	noun	something that is different from normal	oddity, irregularity	*Scientists noticed an anomaly in the climate data.*
anthrop		human	anthropology, philanthropy, misanthrope	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Anthropology	noun	holistic scientific and social study of humanity, mainly using ethnography as its method		*Back then, when I was a young social anthropology academic at our local university, activism was far from my mind.*
anti-		against	antibiotic, antisocial, antidote	
Apathetic		showing no interest	indifferent, unconcerned, uninterested, listless	
Apathy		Not caring at all.	Indifference, Unconcern, Detachment, Lethargy	
Apprenticeship	noun	condition of, or the time served by, an apprentice		*A letter from Jacqui Smith , the skills minister, to the recently formed agency Skills England, last month, asked for urgent advice about which apprenticeship programmes should receive funding increases.*
Apprenticeships	noun	condition of, or the time served by, an		*The Guardian view on apprenticeships: young*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		apprentice		*people need help getting started at work | Editorial Existing staff are taking too much of a fund intended for new recruits.*
Arduous		Needing hard effort.	Difficult, Strenuous, Laborious, Taxing	
Aspiration NEW	noun	act of aspiring or ardently desiring		*Morgan has an aspiration of winning the game.*
Assiduous	adjective	showing great care and effort	root SID/SED=sit at; diligent, hardworking	*Assiduous preparation earned her the top rank.*
Asylum	noun	protection given by a country to someone fleeing danger	refuge, safety, shelter	*The activist sought asylum at a foreign embassy after the crackdown.*
Attainable	adjective	able to be achieved	reachable, doable, achievable	*The UN said the target is attainable with sustained funding.*
Attendance	noun	state of attending		*In most places budgets and classes have been cut and attendance is poor.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
aud		hear	audio, audience, audible, auditorium	
auto		self	automatic, autograph, autonomy, autobiography	
Automation	noun	act or process of converting the controlling of a machine or device to a more automatic system, such as computer or electronic controls	automatisation, automatization	*Australia dock workers call for 28-hour week in AI talks A union says workers are "in the crosshairs" of automation as AI is being tested across ports.*
bene		good	benefit, benevolent, beneficial, benefactor	
bene-		good	benefit, benevolent	
Benevolent		Benevolent means well-meaning and kindly.	Kind	
Benign	adjective	gentle and harmless; not dangerous	kind, gentle, harmless	*What looked like a benign policy change quietly raised the tax burden on small traders.*
bi		two	bicycle, bilingual, binary, bisect	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Bid	noun	an attempt or effort to do something	attempt, try, effort	*In a bid to reduce pollution, the city banned old diesel vehicles.*
bio		life	biology, biography, antibiotic, symbiosis	
Brinkmanship	noun	pushing a dangerous situation to the edge to win	risky pressure tactics	*The nuclear brinkmanship alarmed the world.*
Brittle		Easily broken.	Fragile, Delicate, Frail, Breakable	
Brunt	noun	the main force or worst part of something	impact, force	*Poor families bore the brunt of the price rise.*
Capricious		unpredictable, whimsical	fickle, erratic, mercurial, changeable	
Cardinal		of central importance	fundamental, primary, key, principal	
carn		flesh	carnivore, carnage, incarnate	
Castigate		to criticise severely	reprimand, rebuke, chastise, berate	
Cataclysm		a violent upheaval/disaster	catastrophe, calamity, disaster, upheaval	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Catharsis		emotional release/cleansing	purification, release, purgation, relief	
Caveat	noun	a warning or condition to keep in mind	warning, condition	*The report comes with one caveat: the data is incomplete.*
Characteristic	noun	distinguishing feature of a person or thing	attribute, hallmark, idiosyncrasy	*Yet the characteristic linking them most closely is their rejection of – or failure to grasp – basic moral standards.*
chron		time	chronic, chronology, anachronism	
chrono		time	chronology, chronic, synchronise, chronicle	
Churlish		rude and mean-spirited	boorish, surly, ill-mannered, uncivil	
Cogent	adjective	clear, logical and convincing	strong, clear, convincing	*The defence presented a cogent argument that the evidence had been gathered unlawfully.*
cogn		know	cognition, recognise, incognito	
Collective	noun	farm owned by a collection of people		*The question for NATO: How much, and how, to*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				spend on collective defence
Commodity	noun	a basic traded good like oil, gold, wheat or metal	raw good, traded item, basic product	*Commodity prices soared as the war disrupted supplies of wheat and crude oil.*
Complicit	adjective	taking part in or helping with something wrong	involved, guilty, helping	*The report suggests that some officials were complicit in covering up the scam.*
Comprise	verb	to be made up of parts	consist of, contain, include	*The survey comprises responses from forty countries.*
Concede	verb	to admit something is true or to give in	admit, accept, give in	*The chief minister finally conceded that the relief work had been delayed.*
Conceivably	adverb	it is possible to imagine; it could possibly happen	possibly, maybe, it could be	*The drug could conceivably be repurposed to treat other inflammatory diseases.*
Confidence	noun	Self-assurance		*From the very start, confidence in a bright, exceptional US future was combined with foreboding and doubt.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Considerable	noun	thing to be considered, consideration		*A considerable part of the attraction of Vienna relates to its large social-housing stock.*
Considerations	noun	thought process of considering, of taking multiple or specified factors into account	deliberation, thought, factor	*Need for inclusive, integrated climate action Climate and heat considerations should be integrated into occupational health policies for municipal and contracted sanitation workers*
Conspicuous		Easily seen / standing out.	Obvious, Prominent, Noticeable, Striking	
Constituency	noun	the group of voters in an area, or the people a leader represents	voter base, district, supporters	*The minister risked alienating her rural constituency by backing the unpopular land reform.*
Constitution	noun	act, or process of setting something up, or establishing something	configuration, form	*A legislative tangle in Maharashtra The grey areas in the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution needs urgent revisiting*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Constitutional	noun	walk that is taken regularly for good health and wellbeing		*At the close of the 1787 constitutional convention, a woman approached one of the founding fathers, Benjamin Franklin, to ask if the delegates had established a monarchy or a republic.*
Construction	noun	process of constructing	building	*Fragmented accountability: On the Taratala warehouse collapse in Kolkata Corruption at all levels takes a toll on lives at construction sites*
Contagious	adjective	Easily transmitted to others	catching, infectious, infectious	*The immorality of world leaders is contagious.*
Contiguous	adjective	touching or next to each other	touching, neighbouring, joined	*The disease spread quickly across contiguous districts.*
Contingent	adjective	depending on something else happening first	depending on, based on, conditional	*Further funding is contingent on the government meeting its reform targets.*
Contributing	verb	give something that is or becomes part of a		*This moves attention from those at risk to*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		larger whole		*those contributing to creating risk*
Cooperation	noun	act of cooperating		*Sharing waters: On the Tungabhadra model The Tungabhadra dam is a good example of inter-State cooperation*
Cordial		Warm and polite.	Warm, Friendly, Hearty, Genial	
Credible	adjective	able to be believed or trusted	believable, trusted, reliable	*Without credible evidence, the police could not file a charge sheet against the accused.*
Credulous	adjective	too ready to believe things	root CRED=believe; gullible, naive	*Credulous investors lost money in the fake scheme.*
Cynical	adjective	believing people act only out of self-interest	distrustful, sceptical	*Voters have grown cynical about politicians' promises.*
Data	noun	facts, numbers, or information collected for study	facts, figures, information	*The data showed that vaccination rates rose sharply after the campaign began.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
de facto	phrase	Latin for 'in fact'; existing in reality even if not officially	in practice, actually, in reality	*With no formal treaty, the ceasefire became the de facto policy along the border.*
Default	noun	failure to repay a debt as promised	non-payment, missed payment, failure to pay	*Argentina edged toward another sovereign default after talks with creditors collapsed.*
Delineate	verb	to describe or mark out something clearly and in detail	outline, describe, draw	*The report delineates three possible pathways by which the country could reach net-zero emissions by 2050.*
Demographic	adjective	relating to the makeup of a population (age, income, race, etc.)	population-based, group-related	*The party's defeat reflected deep demographic shifts, as younger voters abandoned its traditional base.*
Demolish		To knock down completely.	Destroy, Raze, Wreck, Flatten	
Dependence	noun	state of being dependent, of relying upon another		*Changed reality: On India and the Strait of Hormuz India must reduce its dependence on the Strait of Hormuz*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Deploy	verb	to put resources or people into action where needed	send, use, put to work	*The UN deployed emergency teams to the flood zone within forty-eight hours.*
Deride	verb	to make fun of someone in a cruel way	mock, laugh at, insult	*Critics were quick to deride the scheme as a publicity stunt with little real benefit.*
Derive	verb	to get or work out something from a source	get from, draw from, obtain	*The figures were derived from census records going back fifty years.*
Destination	noun	act of destining or appointing		*What used to be a meandering journey is now an immediate arrival at your destination.*
Deteriorating	adjective	getting worse over time	worsening, falling, weakening	*The deteriorating air quality in Delhi has forced the government to shut schools for several days each winter.*
Devaluation	noun	an official lowering of a currency's value against others	lowering, markdown, cut in value	*China's surprise devaluation of the yuan rattled global markets for several weeks.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Diaspora	noun	a people scattered far from their original homeland	scattered community, migrants abroad, exiles	*The diaspora sent billions home in remittances each year.*
Diminishing returns	noun	the point where extra effort or input gives less and less benefit	less and less gain, smaller payoff, fading benefit	*After a certain dose, the drug showed diminishing returns and no extra effect.*
Discard		To get rid of.	Throw away, Dump, Jettison, Scrap	
Discernible	adjective	able to be seen or noticed, if you look carefully	noticeable, visible, clear	*There was no discernible difference between the treated and untreated groups.*
Discernment	noun	good judgement in telling things apart	good judgement, insight, care	*Reviewers praised the author's discernment in weighing the evidence.*
Disobedience NEW	noun	Refusal to obey	contumacy, rebellion	*A civil disobedience movement is showing how to beat the far right At 5am on Saturday morning, I found myself jogging across a field with a few hundred strangers, on my way to block a highway.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Disparage		to belittle	denigrate, deprecate, decry, demean	
Dissent	noun	strong disagreement with an official idea or decision	protest, disagreement, objection	*In a healthy democracy, the right to dissent must be protected rather than treated as a crime.*
Dissident	noun	a person who openly disagrees with and opposes the government	opponent, rebel, critic	*The jailed dissident became a global symbol of resistance against the authoritarian regime.*
doc		teach	doctor, document, docile, doctrine	
Dormant	adjective	not active for now but able to become active later	sleeping, inactive, resting	*The peace deal only kept the conflict dormant; the underlying disputes were never resolved.*
Downturn	noun	a period when business and the economy get worse	slump, dip, slowdown	*Retailers slashed prices to survive the sharpest downturn in consumer spending in years.*
Dwell	verb	to keep thinking or talking about something for a long time	focus, linger, brood	*Instead of dwelling on past failures, the new policy looks ahead to long-term reform.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Electorate	noun	all the people who are allowed to vote in an election	the voters, voting public	*Pollsters struggled to read an electorate that was angrier and more unpredictable than in past cycles.*
Electronically 🆕	adverb	By means of electronics, or of electronic technology		*It handed her a fine of €100,000 (£85,000) and a commuted prison sentence, the remaining year of which would be served by Le Pen being electronically tagged.*
Elucidate	verb	to make something clear by explaining it fully	explain, clarify, clear up	*The authors elucidate the mechanism by which the drug lowers blood pressure.*
Emanate	verb	to come out from a source	come from, flow out, arise	*Much of the criticism appears to emanate from those who feel left out of the reforms.*
Embellish		To make more beautiful.	Decorate, Adorn, Beautify, Ornament	
Empathy	noun	ability to share another's feelings	root PATH=feeling + EM=in; understanding	*Good leaders show empathy in a crisis.*
Emulate	verb	to copy someone because you admire	copy, imitate, follow	*Other states would do well to emulate Kerala's*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		them and want to do as well		*success in raising literacy levels.*
Encroach	verb	To slowly move into or take over land, rights, or space that is not yours	intrude, creep in, trespass	*Farms are increasingly encroaching on protected rainforest land.*
Enigmatic		puzzling, mysterious	mysterious, cryptic, inscrutable, baffling	
Environmental	adjective	Pertaining to the environment		*Rice-to-ethanol policy is deepening economic and environmental stress*
Envoy	noun	an official sent by a government to represent it abroad	messenger, representative, diplomat	*A special envoy was dispatched to broker talks between the rivals.*
Epistemic	adjective	about knowledge - how we know what we know, and how sure we can be	to do with knowing, knowledge-based	*The report warns of an epistemic crisis, in which citizens can no longer agree on basic facts.*
Epitome		a perfect example	embodiment, personification, archetype, essence	
equ		equal	equal, equate, equanimity, equivalent	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Equanimity		mental calmness	composure, poise, serenity, aplomb	
Eradicate		To remove completely.	Eliminate, Abolish, Exterminate, Uproot	
Erstwhile	adjective	former; from an earlier time	former, past, old	*The erstwhile rivals surprised everyone by sharing the stage at the rally.*
Erudite		scholarly, learned	knowledgeable, learned, scholarly, well-read	
Establishment	noun	act of establishing	foundation	*His argument is a con: that the "establishment" should not judge him over million-pound gifts; only the voters should.*
Euphony		a pleasant sound	melody, harmony, musicality	
Evacuation	noun	act of evacuating		*Wildfire in southern France forces evacuation of 10,000 people Tour de France organisers ban spectators from stage three as a wildfire hits the Pyrénées-Orientales region.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Evidence	noun	facts or signs that show something is true	proof, facts, signs	*There is growing evidence that the new drug lowers blood pressure in older patients.*
ex-		out/former	exit, export, ex-president	
Examination	noun	act of examining		*Fixing the rot: On the subversion of public examinations and recruitment There seems a recurring pattern in the examination paper leaks across States*
Excoriate		to criticise harshly	censure, lambaste, castigate, flay	
Exculpate		to free from guilt	exonerate, absolve, acquit, clear	
Exoneration	noun	act of disburdening, discharging, or freeing morally from a charge or imputation		*Rather than wait for the exoneration he insists is inevitable, Mr Farage says he will resign as MP for Clacton and stand again.*
Explicit		clearly and directly stated	clear, definite, unambiguous, express	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Extrapolate	verb	to use known data to estimate something beyond it	predict, estimate, project	*From current trends, economists extrapolate that the debt will double within fifteen years.*
Facet	noun	one side or part of something	side, part, aspect	*The report examines every facet of the rural employment crisis.*
Facile		easy / superficial	effortless, simplistic, shallow, glib	
Facilitate	verb	to make a process easier	help, ease, assist	*The new platform facilitates data sharing between hospitals.*
Facilitation	noun	act of facilitating or making easy		| *Marina Hyde Joy is unbounded and when it dies down perhaps the guilty will be held to account for cheating and facilitation: perhaps they won't.*
Factor in	verb	to include something when you make a calculation or decision	include, count, allow for	*Once you factor in rising fuel costs, the savings almost disappear.*
Fastidious		very fussy, hard to please	meticulous, finicky, particular, choosy	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
fer		carry/bring	transfer, refer, confer, fertile	
Fiasco		a complete failure	debacle, disaster, flop, catastrophe	
fid		faith/trust	fidelity, confide, bona fide, infidel	
Fidelity	noun	faithfulness; loyalty	root FID=faith; devotion	*The contract demands strict fidelity to the rules.*
Flounder	verb	to struggle and fail to make progress	struggle, fail, stumble	*The startup began to flounder once funding dried up and orders slowed sharply.*
fore-		before/front	forecast, foresee, forehead	
Framework	noun	a basic structure of rules or ideas used to plan something	plan, structure, system	*The Paris Agreement provides a global framework for cutting greenhouse gas emissions.*
Franchise	noun	the right to vote in elections	the vote, voting right	*The 1928 reform finally extended the franchise to all women over twenty-one.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Fraught	adjective	full of problems, danger or worry	risky, tense, worried	*The border talks remained fraught with mistrust on both sides.*
Gauche		socially awkward	clumsy, tactless, inept, maladroit	
gen		birth/race	generate, genesis, genetics, genocide	
geo		earth	geography, geology, geometry, geothermal	
Geopolitical NEW	adjective	Of, or relating to geopolitics		*How India withstood the crisis in West Asia India had quietly built an insurance policy against geopolitical shocks by diversifying its supplier base*
Gerrymander	verb	to redraw voting area borders unfairly to help one party win	rig, manipulate, twist	*Critics allege the new constituency map was gerrymandered to favour the ruling party.*
Glib		fluent but insincere	smooth-talking, slick, facile, suave	
Globalisation	noun	process of becoming a more interconnected world		*"I hear people say we have to stop and debate globalisation," he said .*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Governance	noun	the way a country or organisation is run and controlled	management, ruling, running	*Weak governance and corruption slowed the delivery of aid, according to the World Bank assessment.*
Grandstanding	noun	acting or speaking only to impress people, not to help	showing off, posing, boasting	*Critics dismissed the leader's remarks as mere grandstanding ahead of the budget session.*
graph/gram		write/draw	autograph, telegram, photograph, diagram	
Grassroots	adjective	starting from ordinary people at the local level, not from leaders at the top	local, bottom-up, community	*The campaign relied on a grassroots network of volunteers rather than wealthy corporate donors.*
Gregarious	adjective	fond of company; very social and friendly	social, friendly, outgoing	*The gregarious leader drew large crowds wherever his roadshow travelled.*
Haughty		Thinking you're better than others.	Arrogant, Proud, Disdainful, Snobbish	
Hegemon	noun	a country or group that dominates and controls others	leader, boss, ruler	*Smaller nations fear the rising hegemon will*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				dictate terms of regional trade.
Henceforth	adverb	from now on; starting from this time	from now on, in future, after this	*The agency announced that, henceforth, all data would be made public.*
Hitherto	adverb	up until now; before this time	so far, until now, previously	*The telescope revealed structures hitherto unseen at the edge of the galaxy.*
Humiliation	noun	act of humiliating or humbling someone	abasement, dishonor, embarrassment	*I always knew that life under occupation was built on violence, humiliation and fear.*
hydro		water	hydrogen, dehydrate, hydroelectric	
Hypothesis	noun	an idea or guess that you test to see if it is true	guess, idea, theory	*Researchers tested the hypothesis that warmer oceans speed up the spread of the disease.*
Iconoclast		one who attacks traditions	rebel, dissenter, nonconformist, maverick	
Ignominy		public shame, humiliation	disgrace, dishonour, humiliation, infamy	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Immigration	noun	act of immigrating		*Supreme Court snubs Trump on immigration, but he could use new tools*
Impeccable		faultless	flawless, perfect, unblemished, exemplary	
Imperious		arrogantly commanding	domineering, overbearing, high-handed	
Impervious		not affected/penetrated	resistant, immune, impenetrable, unaffected	
Imprisonment NEW	noun	confinement in a place, especially a prison or a jail, as punishment for a crime	incarceration, jaildom	*German doctor jailed for murder of 15 patients and suspected of more The German palliative care doctor has been sentenced to life imprisonment for killing 15 of his patients.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Impunity	noun	freedom from being punished for a wrong act	no punishment, escape, freedom	*The editorial warned that when powerful officials act with impunity, ordinary citizens lose all faith in the rule of law.*
in-/im-/il-/ir-		not	inactive, impossible, illegal, irregular	
Inadvertent	adjective	done without intention, by accident	accidental, unintended	*An inadvertent error delayed the entire project.*
Inappropriate	adjective	Not appropriate	improper, out of line, unfit	*Australian PM apologises for 'inappropriate' comments about Kylie Minogue Albanese has apologised 'unequivocally' after his remarks prompted a backlash.*
Incessant		never-ending	ceaseless, constant, continual, perpetual	
Inclusive	adjective	including everyone, leaving no group out	open, welcoming, for all	*The UN praised the country's inclusive policy that brought women into the workforce.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Incredulous	adjective	unwilling to believe something	root CRED=believe + IN=not; disbelieving	*She gave an incredulous look at the sudden claim.*
Indefatigable		tireless	untiring, unflagging, tireless, persistent	
Indicate	verb	to show or point to something	show, point to, suggest	*Early results indicate that the vaccine is safe for young children.*
Indigenous	adjective	Belonging naturally to a place; the original people or species of a region	native, original, local	*The dam project threatens lands long held by indigenous communities.*
Indigent		very poor, needy	destitute, impoverished, penniless	
Indispensable	noun	thing that is not dispensable		*However bright you shine, you're never so indispensable that you couldn't be replaced tomorrow – or so, at least, convention has it.*
Individual	noun	person considered alone, rather than as belonging to a group of people		*In an ostensibly secular age, 76% of people worldwide identified with a religion in 2020 – a potent expression of*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				individual and collective morality.
Indomitable		impossible to defeat	unconquerable, invincible, unyielding, resolute	
Ineffable		too great to express in words	indescribable, inexpressible, unutterable	
Inequality	noun	unfair, not equal, state	inequation	*A broken housing market is driving inequality right across Europe – and fuelling the far right | Kirsty Major From Lisbon to Amsterdam, housing policy has led to haves and have-nots.*
Inexperience	noun	lack of experience		*He has the makings of a great ally | Jessica Berlin Defence strategists fret about the next PM's inexperience.*
Infrastructure	noun	underlying base or foundation especially for an organization or system	underbuilding	*Falling behind: On Mumbai and the monsoon Urbanisation in Mumbai is evolving*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				faster than its infrastructure upgrades
Inherent	adjective	existing as a natural, permanent part of something; built in	built-in, natural, part of	*There is an inherent risk in lending money to unstable governments.*
Inimitable	adjective	so good or unique it cannot be copied	one-of-a-kind, special, unmatched	*The veteran cartoonist captured the nation's mood with his inimitable wit.*
Innate		inborn, natural	inborn, inherent, intrinsic, congenital	
Innocuous	adjective	harmless	safe, harmless	*What seemed an innocuous remark triggered a big row.*
Innovation	noun	act of innovating		*Beyond three Cs, the new lexicon of India-Australia ties A growing partnership now spans trade, defence, energy, education and innovation*
Insatiable	adjective	impossible to satisfy; always wanting more	greedy, never full, endless	*The city's insatiable demand for water is rapidly draining the lakes around it.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Inscrutable		impossible to interpret	unfathomable, impenetrable, mysterious	
Insofar	adverb	to the extent that; only as far as	as much as, to the point that, where	*The model is useful insofar as it predicts short-term shifts, but it fails over longer periods.*
insofar as	phrase	to the extent that; only as much as	as far as, to the degree that	*The plan helps the poor only insofar as funds actually reach them.*
Insolent		rudely disrespectful	impertinent, impudent, insulting, cheeky	
Insolvent	adjective	unable to pay one's debts	broke, bankrupt, ruined	*Several power companies turned insolvent after the regulator slashed tariffs.*
Inspectorate	noun	organized group of inspectors		*In a survey for the inspectorate, 34% of male prisoners reported spending more than 22 hours a day locked in their cells.*
Insular	adjective	closed off and not open to other ideas or people	closed, narrow, cut-off	*Critics say the party's insular leadership has lost touch with the*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				aspirations of young India.
Insurgency	noun	an armed uprising against a government	rebellion, revolt, uprising	*The decade-long insurgency has displaced millions across the region.*
Insurmountable	adjective	too great to be overcome	impossible, too big, unbeatable	*With political will, even seemingly insurmountable challenges of poverty can be tackled.*
Intelligence 🆕	noun	Capacity of mind, especially to understand principles, truths, facts or meanings, acquire knowledge, and apply it to practice	brightness, intellect, wit	*Maybe Anthropic and OpenAI are not the future of artificial intelligence.*
inter alia	phrase	'among other things' - shows the listed items are only some of many	among other things, including	*The report criticised, inter alia, weak data and poor oversight.*
inter-		between	international, interact, intervene	
International	noun	Someone who has represented their		*A hold on AI: on the Preliminary Report of the Independent*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		country in a particular sport		*International Scientific Panel on AI AI holds scientific promise, but it should not unfold unchecked*
Interrogation	noun	act of interrogating or questioning		*Nigeria says two nationals killed in South Africa amid rise of anti-migrant attacks Nigeria's government said one of its nationals was reportedly killed by police officers "using gruesome interrogation techniques".*
intra-		within	intranet, intravenous	
Intrinsic	adjective	belonging naturally to something	natural, built-in, basic	*Trust is an intrinsic part of any functioning market.*
Inundate		to flood / overwhelm	flood, swamp, deluge, overwhelm	
Inveterate		long-established, habitual	confirmed, chronic, ingrained, hardened	
Inviolable		must never be broken	sacrosanct, sacred, unassailable, secure	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Invitation NEW	noun	act of inviting	invitement	*Farewell to Jackass, the finest catalogue of male idiocy – it could only go on for so long | Tom Usher When I was 12, the antics of Johnny Knoxville, Steve-O and co were an invitation to jump out of trees.*
Irrigation NEW	noun	act or process of irrigating, or the state of being irrigated		*40 years ago, July 9, 1986: PM Rajiv Gandhi criticises irrigation planning*
Jaded		tired and bored from overuse	weary, world-weary, sated, fatigued	
Juncture	noun	an important point in time	moment, point, stage	*At this critical juncture, the economy needs steady hands rather than populist promises.*
Jurisprudence	noun	the study or philosophy of law	law theory, legal thinking, law study	*The verdict marks an important advance in Indian environmental jurisprudence.*
Knell	noun	a sign or sound warning that something is ending or dying	death sign, warning bell, end signal	*Falling enrolment may sound the knell for hundreds of small*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				government schools across the state.
Lavish		Spending/giving very freely.	Extravagant, Generous, Opulent, Profuse	
Levy	noun/verb	a tax or charge placed by the government	tax, charge, fee	*The new levy on imported goods drew sharp criticism from traders.*
Liminal	adjective	being at a boundary or in-between, transitional stage	in-between, borderline, transitional	*The economy occupies a liminal space, no longer poor but not yet rich, where old policies no longer fit.*
Linear	adjective	changing at a steady, straight-line rate	straight, even, steady	*The relationship between dose and effect was roughly linear up to a point.*
Litany	noun	a long, repeated list, usually of complaints or problems	long list, string, series	*The audit report reads like a litany of lapses, from missing files to inflated bills.*
Lopsided	adjective	uneven or unbalanced	uneven, unequal	*Critics called the deal lopsided and unfair.*
Macabre		gruesome, disturbing	grisly, gruesome, ghastly, morbid	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Magnanimity		generosity of spirit	generosity, nobility, benevolence, charity	
Magnanimous		generous, big-hearted	benevolent, generous, charitable, noble	
Maladroit		clumsy, unskilful	inept, bungling, gauche, awkward	
Malnutrition	noun	lack of adequate nourishment		*How schools can tackle adolescent malnutrition Physical inactivity must be treated as seriously as poor diet.*
Manifest	verb	to show or appear clearly	show, appear, reveal	*The disease often manifests as fatigue long before other symptoms emerge.*
Manifold	adjective	many and of several kinds	many, varied, numerous	*The benefits of vaccination are manifold and well documented.*
Maverick		an independent nonconformist	rebel, individualist, free spirit, dissenter	
max		greatest	maximum, maximise	
Mellifluous		sweet-sounding (voice/music)	dulcet, honeyed, melodious, euphonious	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
min		small/less	minimum, minor, diminish, minute	
Misappropriation 🆕	noun	wrongful, fraudulent or corrupt use of other's funds in one's care	embezzlement	*For a few hours, it looked as though the court of appeal had unexpectedly played a masterful hand by unequivocally upholdingthe far-right National Rally (RN) figurehead's conviction for misappropriation of public funds.*
Misconception	noun	mistaken belief, a wrong idea		*In doing so, society is gradually internalising a dangerous misconception that AI generates knowledge*
Misnomer	noun	a wrong or unsuitable name for something	wrong name, false label, misleading title	*Calling the levy a 'service charge' is a misnomer, since citizens get no service in return.*
mit/miss		send	transmit, mission, dismiss, submit	
Mobilisation	noun	act of mobilising		*While companies are yet to respond to the demands for better pay*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				and conditions, the mobilisation was a clear step-up for a process of national organisation that began in 2020.
mono		one/single	monarch, monopoly, monotone, monologue	
mort		death	mortal, mortuary, immortal, mortician	
Motivation	noun	Willingness of action especially in behavior		*She shares her motivation to find new solutions on "The Ezra Klein Show."*
multi		many	multiple, multitude, multimedia	
Munificence	noun	great generosity in giving	generosity, giving, kindness	*The trust survives on the munificence of a few wealthy donors.*
Munificent	adjective	very generous in giving	generous, giving, kind	*The munificent corporate donations to the relief fund were welcome, yet they masked the state's own failures.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
nat		born	native, nation, natal, innate	
Nationalism	noun	strong loyalty to one's own nation, often above other nations	patriotism, national pride, loyalty	*Rising nationalism has made cross-border cooperation far harder.*
Negligence	noun	failure to take proper care	carelessness, neglect, oversight	*The inquiry blamed the disaster on official negligence.*
Negligible	adjective	so small it can be safely ignored	tiny, unimportant, barely there	*The added risk from the chemical was found to be negligible at normal doses.*
Nemesis		an unbeatable rival / downfall	archenemy, downfall, undoing, bane	
Nominal	adjective	in name only; very small or not really meaningful	in name only, tiny, slight	*The state retains nominal control of the port, but a foreign firm runs daily operations.*
non-		not	nonsense, nonstop, nonfiction	
nota bene	abbreviation	'note well' (often written N.B.) - draws attention to an important point	note this, take note, important	*N.B.: the figures exclude inflation, the authors stressed.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Notable	adjective	important or worth noticing	important, well-known, special	*There has been a notable improvement in literacy rates over the decade.*
Notifiable	adjective	That may be notified		*Counting cancer: On making cancer a notifiable disease in India Making cancer a notifiable disease at the national level is the way forward*
Nullify	verb	to make something lose its legal force or value; to cancel it	cancel, void, undo	*The High Court moved to nullify the contract awarded without open bidding.*
Observe	verb	to watch carefully and notice what happens	watch, notice, see	*Astronomers observed the distant star dimming over several weeks.*
Obstreperous		noisy and unruly	unruly, boisterous, rowdy, disorderly	
Occupation	noun	activity or task with which one occupies oneself	employment, interest, line of work	*I always knew that life under occupation was built on violence, humiliation and fear.*
Occupational	adjective	Of, belonging or relating to an		*Need for inclusive, integrated climate*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		occupation		*action Climate and heat considerations should be integrated into occupational health policies for municipal and contracted sanitation workers*
omni		all	omnipresent, omnipotent, omniscient	
Ostensibly	adverb	according to what is claimed, though perhaps not truly	supposedly, apparently, seemingly	*The troops were sent ostensibly to keep the peace, but critics saw a land grab.*
Ostracise		to exclude/banish	shun, exclude, banish, blackball	
over-		too much	overeat, overwork, overflow	
Overheating	noun	an economy growing too fast, risking high inflation	running too hot, overgrowth, boiling over	*Analysts warned of overheating as cheap credit fuelled runaway property prices.*
Palpable	adjective	so strong it can almost be felt or touched	clear, obvious, strong	*There was palpable anger among voters over the sudden hike in electricity bills.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Pandemic	noun	A disease outbreak that spreads across many countries or the whole world	global outbreak, plague, epidemic	*The Lancet study modelled how quickly a new pandemic could spread.*
Pariah		a social outcast	outcast, untouchable, leper, undesirable	
Parsimonious		extremely stingy	miserly, niggardly, tight-fisted, frugal	
Partisanship	noun	strong, often blind loyalty to one's own political party	party loyalty, bias, side-taking	*Deep partisanship in the legislature stalled even routine bills that once passed with broad support.*
path		feeling/disease	sympathy, empathy, apathy, pathology	
Pedantic		over-concerned with rules/detail	bookish, dogmatic, fussy, hairsplitting	
Penurious		extremely poor / stingy	destitute, indigent, impoverished; miserly	
Penury	noun	the state of being extremely poor	poverty, want, hardship	*A single hospital bill can push a near-poor family back into penury, the survey warns.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
per capita	phrase	Latin for 'per head' - for each person, used when comparing countries or groups	per person, for each person	*Per capita income in the region has doubled over the past two decades.*
Perfidious		treacherous, disloyal	treacherous, traitorous, faithless, deceitful	
Perfidy	noun	the act of betraying trust; disloyalty	betrayal, cheating, lies	*Allies accused the regime of perfidy after it broke the ceasefire pact.*
Performance	noun	act of performing		*The Art of Summitry The performance is meant to imply that the world is an orderly place, or at least a place on which reasonable people are determined to impose some order.*
Performative NEW	noun	performative utterance		*According to Molly Jong-Fast, there's value to performative politics.*
Peripatetic	adjective	travelling from place to place; not settled in one spot	travelling, roaming, wandering	*The peripatetic life of migrant workers leaves their children with broken, interrupted schooling.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Pernickety		fussy about small details	finicky, fastidious, fussy, particular	
Perplex		To confuse greatly.	Confuse, Baffle, Puzzle, Bewilder	
phil		love	philosophy, philanthropy, bibliophile	
phon		sound	telephone, phonetics, symphony, microphone	
photo		light	photograph, photosynthesis, photon	
Pious		religiously devoted	devout, reverent, godly, spiritual	
Plateau	noun	a level where something stops rising and stays flat	flat stage, level off, steady point	*After years of rapid growth, vaccination rates have hit a plateau across the region.*
Plebiscite	noun	a direct vote by all the people on a single important question	public vote, referendum	*The government called a plebiscite to let citizens decide directly whether to amend the constitution.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Polity	noun	an organised society or state with its own form of government	state, society, nation	*A healthy polity, the scholars argued, depends on citizens who trust shared institutions.*
poly		many	polygon, polyglot, polygamy	
Pompous		self-important, grandiose	pretentious, bombastic, grandiloquent	
port		carry	portable, transport, export, import	
pos/pon		place/put	position, postpone, compose, deposit	
post-		after	postpone, postscript, postwar	
Postulate	verb	to suggest an idea as a starting point, before it is proven	suggest, propose, assume	*The authors postulate that warming oceans are driving the change in fish migration.*
pre-		before	preview, predict, prepare, prefix	
Precarious	adjective	unsafe, uncertain, or dangerous	risky, shaky	*Millions live in precarious financial conditions.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Preliminary	adjective	coming before the main part; early	early, first, initial	*Preliminary results suggest the vaccine is safe.*
Preparation	noun	act of preparing or getting ready		*The criteria on which inspectors judge prisons are safety, respect, preparation for release and purposeful activity.*
Preservation	noun	act of preserving		*Never would I have imagined that 35 years later, I would be speaking at a rally in the same square, this time urging the preservation of democracy.*
Presidential	adjective	Pertaining to a president or presidency		*Marine Le Pen appeal verdict: Why this moment matters for France The leader of France's National Rally leads the opinion polls ahead of the 2027 presidential election and will now find out if she can stand.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Presumably	adverb	probably; this is what we assume without full proof	probably, likely, I assume	*The funds were, presumably, redirected to defence, though the budget gave no clear breakdown.*
Pretentious		trying to seem important	affected, showy, grandiose, snobbish	
Prevailing	adjective	most common or widely accepted at a given time	common, usual, dominant	*The prevailing view among analysts is that interest rates will hold steady.*
Previously	adverb	First		*Inspectors who visited two homes in England – which had previously been rated good and outstanding – found "high levels of distress" and staff as well as children feeling unsafe.*
prima facie	phrase	on first look; based on what seems true at first	at first sight, on the surface, apparently	*There is prima facie evidence of fraud, though a full inquiry is still needed.*
Pristine		spotlessly clean / original	immaculate, unspoiled, pure, untouched	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
pro rata	adjective	in proportion; shared according to each share or part	in proportion, share by share	*Losses were split pro rata among the shareholders.*
Prodigal		wastefully extravagant	spendthrift, lavish, profligate, wasteful	
Profane		disrespectful to sacred things	blasphemous, irreverent, sacrilegious	
Professional 🆕	noun	person who belongs to a profession		*I was already obsessed with professional wrestling.*
Prohibition	noun	act of prohibiting, forbidding, disallowing, or proscribing something	forbode	*There is already a worldwide legal prohibition.*
Projection	noun	a forecast of what a number will be in the future	forecast, prediction, outlook	*IMF projections suggest the economy will grow by three percent next year.*
Promulgate		to make known publicly	proclaim, announce, declare, publicise	
Pronounced	adjective	very clear and strong; easy to notice	strong, marked, obvious	*The effect was most pronounced among children under the age of five.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Prospective	adjective	likely to happen or be in the future	future, expected, possible	*The trial followed prospective patients over five years.*
Protectionism	noun	shielding home industries by taxing or blocking foreign goods	trade barriers, home-favouring, walls on trade	*Rising protectionism threatened to unravel decades of open global trade.*
psych		mind	psychology, psychic, psychiatry	
Pulchritude		physical beauty	beauty, loveliness, comeliness, grace	
Purported	adjective	claimed to be, but not proven	alleged, supposed, so-called	*The purported recording of the call could not be confirmed as genuine.*
Putrid		rotten, decaying	decayed, rotten, decomposed, festering	
Pyrrhic	adjective	a win that costs so much it feels like a loss	costly victory	*It was a Pyrrhic victory — they won the case but lost everything.*
Querulous	adjective	complaining in an irritated, whining way	complaining, whining, grumpy	*The minister dismissed the querulous opposition as unwilling to offer real solutions.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Quintessential	adjective	the most perfect example of something	typical, classic	*It was a quintessential case of bureaucratic delay.*
Rapacious		aggressively greedy	grasping, voracious, predatory, avaricious	
Rapprochement	noun	a renewal of friendly relations between countries after tension	making up, warming ties, reconciliation	*Trade talks signalled a cautious rapprochement between the old foes.*
Ratio	noun	a way of comparing two amounts by how many times one fits the other	proportion, balance, rate	*The study reported a ratio of three women to every two men in the workforce.*
Recession	noun	a period when the economy shrinks and business slows for months	slowdown, slump, hard times	*The IMF warned that rising interest rates could push the eurozone into a mild recession.*
Reel	verb	to be badly shaken or struggling	suffer	*The region is reeling under a severe drought.*
Representatives NEW	noun	delegate	rep	*Lessons From the Graham Platner Disaster Many Democrats want representatives as furious as they are.*
Requisite	adjective	needed or required for a particular purpose	needed, required, must-have	*Many nurses left because hospitals lacked*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				the requisite funding and staff.
Resignation	noun	act of resigning		*Downing streak: On the Starmer resignation, British politics Labour needs a progressive makeover to survive the far-right onslaught*
Resistance	noun	act of resisting, or the capacity to resist	opposition	*the resistance of bacteria to certain antibiotics*
Reverence		Deep respect.	Respect, Awe, Veneration, Admiration	
Reverent		showing deep respect	respectful, worshipful, devout, awed	
rupt		break	rupture, interrupt, corrupt, bankrupt	
Sacrosanct		too important to interfere with	sacred, inviolable, hallowed, untouchable	
Salient	adjective	most noticeable or important	key, prominent	*The editor summarised the salient points of the report.*
Salubrious		healthy, wholesome	healthful, wholesome, beneficial, hygienic	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Sample	noun	a small group chosen to stand for a much larger group	group, selection, portion	*The survey used a sample of 2,000 adults to represent the whole country.*
Sanctioned	adjective	hit with official penalties (or, confusingly, officially approved)	penalised, punished, banned	*The sanctioned officials are barred from travelling to Europe.*
Sangfroid	noun	calmness under pressure	composure, cool head	*She handled the crisis with remarkable sangfroid.*
Scarce	adjective	very little available; in short supply	rare, few, limited	*Jobs have become scarce for young graduates in small towns.*
sci		know	science, conscious, omniscient, prescient	
Scientific	adjective	Of, or having to do with science	methodical, systematic	*A hold on AI: on the Preliminary Report of the Independent International Scientific Panel on AI AI holds scientific promise, but it should not unfold unchecked*
scrib/script		write	scribble, manuscript, describe, inscription	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Sedentary	adjective	involving much sitting; inactive	root SED=sit; inactive	*A sedentary lifestyle raises health risks.*
semi-		half	semicircle, semifinal	
sens/sent		feel	sensitive, sentiment, consent, resent	
Sentimental	adjective	Characterized by sentiment, sentimentality or excess emotion		*So there was something sentimental for me in watching Jackass: Best and Last.*
Servile		slave-like, submissive	subservient, obsequious, menial, grovelling	
Shipbuilding	noun	construction of ships		*India's shipbuilding ambitions can set sail with Korea South Korean partnerships could help accelerate India's ambitions to become a shipbuilding powerhouse*
Sovereign	adjective	belonging to a national government (often about debt)	national, state, government	*Investors grew nervous as Greece's sovereign debt climbed toward unsustainable levels.*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Speculation	noun	process of thinking or meditating on a subject		*Dior dress, Adam Sandler and a man of honour: What we know about Taylor and Travis's wedding The couple tied the knot in New York on Friday, after months of speculation about when, where and how it would happen.*
Speculative	adjective	based on guessing, not on solid proof	guessing, uncertain, unproven	*Such estimates remain highly speculative until field data become available.*
Sporadic	adjective	happening now and then, not regularly	occasional, scattered, irregular	*Sporadic protests broke out in several districts over the fuel price hike.*
Squalid		dirty and wretched	filthy, dingy, sordid, seedy	
Stagnant	adjective	not moving or growing	still, flat	*Wages have remained stagnant for years.*
Stakeholder	noun	a person or group affected by or interested in a decision	player, party, group involved	*The report urged governments to consult all stakeholders, from farmers to investors,*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				before approving the dam.
status quo	noun	the current situation; the way things are now	the current state, things as they are	*Voters frustrated with the status quo backed the new party.*
Strengthening	verb	make strong or stronger		*| Jaime Palomera While the country's capital is loosening regulations, the Catalan city is strengthening social housing.*
Suave		smoothly polite and charming	urbane, debonair, polished, smooth	
sub-		under/below	submarine, subway, substandard	
Suffrage	noun	the right to vote in political elections	the vote, voting right	*The suffrage movement fought for decades before women were granted equal voting rights.*
Supercilious		arrogantly superior	haughty, disdainful, condescending, snooty	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Surmise	verb	to guess something from the small clues you have	guess, suppose, figure out	*From the wear patterns, archaeologists surmise the tools were used for grinding grain.*
Surreptitious		done secretly	clandestine, furtive, covert, stealthy	
Survey	noun	a set of questions asked to many people to gather information	poll, study, questionnaire	*A nationwide survey found that two in three workers want to keep working from home.*
Sustained	adjective	kept going over time without stopping	steady, ongoing, continued	*Sustained investment lifted millions out of poverty.*
Sycophancy		excessive flattery	obsequiousness, fawning, toadyism, servility	
Sycophant	noun	a person who flatters powerful people to gain favour	flatterer, yes-man	*The leader was surrounded by sycophants, not advisers.*
Synthesis	noun	combining parts into a whole	blend, mixture, combination	*The review offers a synthesis of fifty separate studies.*
Technological	adjective	Of, relating to, or involving technology,		*Reimagining sovereign AI for India's strategic future India must*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
		especially modern scientific technology		*leverage global AI while reducing strategic technological dependence over time*
tele		far	telephone, television, telescope, telepathy	
Tenable	adjective	able to be defended or believed	defensible, reasonable, sound	*Critics argued the theory was no longer tenable.*
Tenacious		Holding on firmly, not giving up.	Persistent, Determined, Dogged, Resolute	
Tenet	noun	a main belief or principle that a group or theory is built on	core belief, principle, key idea	*Free trade is a central tenet of the institution's economic philosophy.*
therm		heat	thermometer, thermal, thermostat	
Traceability	noun	ability to trace all the stages that led to a particular point in a process that consists of a chain of interrelated events		*Buyer beware: On the QR code-based drug traceability framework Tracking down defective batches of drugs is essential*
tract		pull/drag	attract, extract, distract, tractor	
Tractable		easily controlled	docile, compliant, manageable, amenable	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Trajectory	noun	the path or direction something follows over time	path, course, direction	*The country is on a trajectory to miss its emissions targets by 2030.*
trans-		across	transport, translate, transfer	
Transactional	adjective	Of, pertaining to or involving transactions		*Why some African nations are turning down Trump aid money The Trump administration sees the aid as more transactional - but some say it is not a fair trade.*
tri		three	triangle, tripod, trio, trident	
Truncate	verb	to shorten by cutting off	shorten, cut	*The session was truncated due to protests.*
un-		not	unhappy, unfair, unable	
Unaffordable NEW	adjective	Too expensive to be afforded		*But unaffordable house prices and rents are a continent-wide issue.*
Unanimous	adjective	fully agreed by everyone	root UN=one + ANIM=mind; united	*The board gave unanimous approval to*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				the merger.
Unctuous		falsely sweet/flattering	smarmy, oily, ingratiating, gushing	
under-		too little	underpaid, underestimate	
Underestimate NEW	noun	estimate that is too low	underestimation	*It would be foolish to underestimate him.*
Underprepared	adjective	Not adequately prepared		*An overheated Europe, an underprepared world*
Underscore	verb	to give strong emphasis to something	stress, highlight, emphasise	*The findings underscore the urgent need for clean water in the region.*
University	noun	Institution of higher education where subjects are studied and researched in depth and degrees are offered	academy, college, institute	*Back then, when I was a young social anthropology academic at our local university, activism was far from my mind.*
Unprecedented	adjective	never having happened before	unheard-of, novel	*The country faced an unprecedented heatwave this summer.*
Unpredictable NEW	noun	unpredictable thing		*The consequences are alarmingly unpredictable Back in*

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
				2013, when a Socialist minister was accused (and eventually convicted) of tax fraud, the righteous fury of Marine Le Pen knew no bounds.
Untenable	adjective	impossible to defend or maintain	indefensible, shaky	*His position became untenable after the scandal.*
Urbane		suave, polished, refined	sophisticated, suave, cultivated, polished	
Venerable		respected due to age/wisdom	revered, esteemed, honoured, respected	
Venerate		to deeply respect	revere, honour, esteem, worship	
Versatile		Able to do many things well.	Adaptable, All-round, Flexible, Multifaceted	
vert/vers		turn	convert, reverse, divert, versatile	
vice versa	phrase	the other way around; the reverse is also true	the other way round, in reverse	*Exports affect the currency, and vice versa.*
vid/vis		see	video, vision, evident, visible	

Word	Part of Speech	Meaning	Easy Synonyms	Example
Vie	verb	to compete strongly with others for something	compete, fight, contest	*Several states are now vying for the same factory investment with rival tax offers.*
vis-a-vis	preposition	in relation to; compared with; regarding	compared with, about, towards	*The rupee weakened vis-a-vis the dollar over the quarter.*
vita/viv		life	vital, vivid, revive, survive	
Vituperate		to abuse verbally	berate, revile, rail at, castigate	
Volatility	noun	how quickly and sharply prices move up and down	wild swings, ups and downs, instability	*Market volatility spiked as traders reacted to conflicting inflation data.*
Whereby	adverb	by which; through which (a method or arrangement)	by which, through which	*The treaty created a system whereby disputes go to a neutral panel.*
Xenophobia	noun	strong fear or dislike of people from other countries	fear of foreigners, prejudice, hatred	*Editorials warned that rising xenophobia could harm the nation's image as a welcoming land.*

Days merged: 14 (2026-06-25, 2026-06-26, 2026-06-27, 2026-06-28, 2026-06-29, 2026-06-30, 2026-07-01, 2026-07-02, 2026-07-04, 2026-07-05, 2026-07-06, 2026-07-07, 2026-07-08, 2026-07-09)

Sources: Curated word bank + mined editorial words.